
DROPFLEET
COMMANDER



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War has raged across the stars for nine years as humanity fights to reclaim the worlds it lost to the vile Scourge nearly two centuries ago. At its centre, the Battle for Earth has ground into bloody stalemate. The United Colonies of Mankind, the Post Human Republic, Kalium, and Earth's occupied resistance have fought and died together in their mission to rid their birth world of the parasites. But their uneasy alliance is crumbling.

The PHR has suffered a schism, and half are withdrawing without explanation. With its hopes unrealised, the resistance strives for freedom however it can, and Kalium's military dictatorship has claimed its conquests for itself. The hyper-advanced Shaltari, architects of mankind's troubles with the Scourge, disrupts and harries all others, perpetuating the slaughter to their advantage. The UCM, overstretched and depleted, rebuilds, vowing to fight on alone if it must. Their foe is battered but unbroken. Millions of Scourge are still at large on Earth, half its defence grid remains in enemy hands, and an enormous Scourge fleet—the largest single naval force in existence, still lurks somewhere in the void.

At this time of unprecedented strain, a new threat has emerged. The Bioficers, ancient, twisted artificial intelligences and master fleshcrafters, have observed mankind's aptitude for cataclysmic violence—and it pleases them. They have no grand strategy and no goal besides revelling in war and the slow suffering of capable prey. They are a factor apart and may be the greatest threat sentient life has ever faced. They are coming.

Games of Dropfleet Commander

Dropfleet Commander is a competitive, tactical, dynamic tabletop game for two or more players. It is an orbital combat game where fleets of mighty, lavishly detailed spaceship miniatures battle above the surface of a war-torn planet. Bombardment, ground assault and mastery of the orbital layers are just as crucial as annihilating your opponent's ships. Space stations, ground installations, and orbiting scenery are essential elements, but above all, the scenario and its objectives dictate players' aims and who will triumph.

Playing Dropfleet

Players build their own unique fleets, and games vary from small skirmishes to enormous, world-conquering battles. There are six factions to choose from, each with a distinct play style, aesthetic, and extensive range of ships. An array of starship-grade weaponry will be at your disposal, including titanic mass drivers, fearsome lasers, missile clusters, gun broadsides, huge torpedoes, fighters, and bombers. Often essential to victory, specialised strike carriers and troopships carry dozens of bulk landers and swarms of dropships to deliver thousands of ground troops to their objectives.

The Miniatures

The game's extensive multi-part, customisable miniatures range reflects the variety and choice in the rules on the tabletop. Most ships excel at some things and are weak in others; what will be needed depends on your opponent's force and the game's objectives. Balanced, varied fleets are best suited to taking objectives in orbit and on the ground. Bringing a variety of combat capable ships gives you the best chance of combating your opponent and tackling whatever might stand in the way of victory.



All rules for Dropfleet Commander units can be found for free online at:

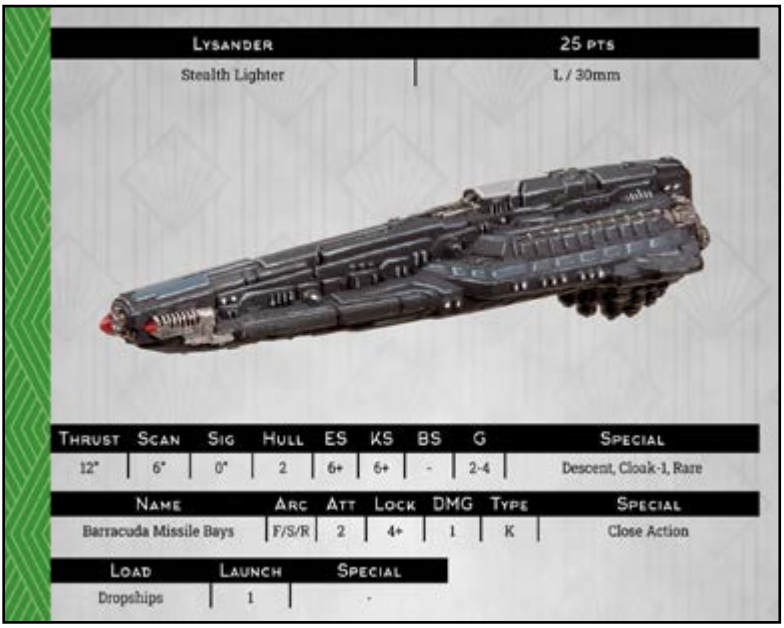
www.dropfleetcommander.com

For those wanting to expand their forces into ground combat, make sure to also check out Dropzone Commander. It has battles fought on the planets below your games of Dropfleet Commander with infantry, tanks, and other war machines all vying to secure your landing zones.

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1. Ship Characteristics

1.1 Stats Bar



Each Ship has a stats bar, with each column showing a different characteristic. Getting to know these stats is the first step towards learning how to play Dropfleet:

1. **Name & Type:** The Ship's class and type.
2. **Points, Tonnage, & Base Size:** How much a Ship costs, what size category it belongs to, and its base size.
3. **Thrust:** How far it can move.
4. **Scan:** How far it can reliably see.
5. **Signature:** How visible it is. The larger a Ship's signature, the further away it can be targeted.
6. **Hull:** The amount of damage it can take before being destroyed.
7. **Energy Save (ES):** Its defence save against Energy hits.
8. **Kinetic Save (KS):** Its defence save against Kinetic hits.
9. **Backup Save (BS):** Some Ships have redundant systems—a last line of defence save.
10. **Group Size (G):** How many of this Ship may operate together as a Group.
11. **Special:** Any special rules the Ship has that are represented by keywords. Any other special rules are described beneath its stats bar.

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1.2 Weapons

Most Ships have Weapons. A Weapon's capabilities are described in its profile:

1. **Name:** The name of the Weapon.
2. **Arc:** The direction/s in which it may attack.
3. **Attack:** The number of dice it attacks with.
4. **Lock:** Its accuracy.
5. **Damage & Type:** The amount and type of damage a successful hit causes.
6. **Special:** Any special rules the Weapon has that are represented by keywords. Any other special rules are described beneath its stats bar.

Sometimes a rule may refer to a **Weapon System**. This is the same row in the weapons table across each Ship in a Group.

1.3 Assets

Usually represented by tokens, Assets are small craft launched from a Carrier, including Fighters, Bombers, and Dropships. Carriers have an additional profile in their characteristics showing what Assets they can launch:

1. **Load:** The type of Asset the Carrier is carrying.
2. **Launch:** How many the Carrier may launch per activation.
3. **Special:** Any special rules the Asset uses while it is being Launched. The special rules used by the Asset itself will be listed in its specific profile.

Disagreements and Rules Conflicts: The rules attempt to cover every conceivable eventuality, but rarely, obscure situations are not addressed. If re-reading the relevant rules section does not provide an answer, and the players cannot agree, have one player roll a dice. On a 1-3 one interpretation is correct, on a 4-6 it is the other.

A Special Rule always overrides a core rule, even if the core rule states that something is impossible.

Tokens



Spikes & Atmosphere marker.



Defence Systems Offline, Fire, Navigation Offline, Orbital Decay, Scanners Offline, & Weapons Offline



Fighters, Bombers, Fire Ships, Torpedo, Mine, Battalion



Activation & Pass Tokens

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2. The Basics

2.1 Dice

Dropfleet uses six-sided dice referred to as **D6**. Most rolls require a specific number or better to succeed and will usually be written without the 'D6', i.e., if a player needs to roll at least a 5 on a D6, that's a 5+.

You will often need to roll multiple D6, sometimes written as X D6, with X being the number of dice to roll.

If you're required to roll a three-sided dice—a D3— you can simulate it using a D6 by halving the result and rounding up. For example, a D6 result of a 1 would still be a D3 result of 1, a D6 result of 5 would become a D3 result of 3.

2.1.1 Dice Roll Modifiers

There are many modifiers that may be applied to dice rolls, from negatives for shooting through scenery to positives from the effects of friendly Ships.

Modifiers that **improve** a dice stat will make it more likely. For example, a 4+ Energy Save improved by 1 becomes a 3+ Energy Save.

Modifiers that **reduce** a dice stat will make it less likely. For example, a 4+ Energy Save reduced by 1 becomes a 5+ Energy Save.

Modifiers are cumulative and cannot make a dice roll impossible or certain. Total up all modifiers to a dice roll before rolling any dice. Dice rolls cannot be modified to be better than a 2+ or worse than a 6+."

2.1.2 Re-rolls

Some rules allow you to re-roll dice—roll the dice again and apply the second result, even if it is worse than the first. **Dice can only be re-rolled once.**

2.2 Measuring

Dropfleet uses inches, so players need a tape measure or ruler marked in inches. Shorthand for inches is used: 12" means 12 inches.

2.2.1 Pre-measuring

You may pre-measure distances at any time.

2.3 Gaming Pieces

2.3.1 Miniatures

Miniatures are the Ship and Space Station models used for playing the game, which all sit on bases. **All distances are measured to and from a base's stem unless otherwise stated**. Distances to and from tokens and Cities are measured to the centre of the base or token.

2.3.1.1 Base Contact

Bases and the edges of tokens which are touching are referred to as being in base contact.

Bases cannot overlap. If a rule would cause one to overlap with another, it is instead shifted the minimum distance so that they are in contact but not overlapping. Ships that overlap due to movement are instead moved back along their path of travel until they are in contact but not overlapping.

Sometimes by choice or necessity you may move a Ship close to, but not into base contact. If this happens, communicate this with your opponent so there is no confusion over what is in base contact and what is not.

Ships within a Group move together, so only resolve any overlapping bases once all have moved.

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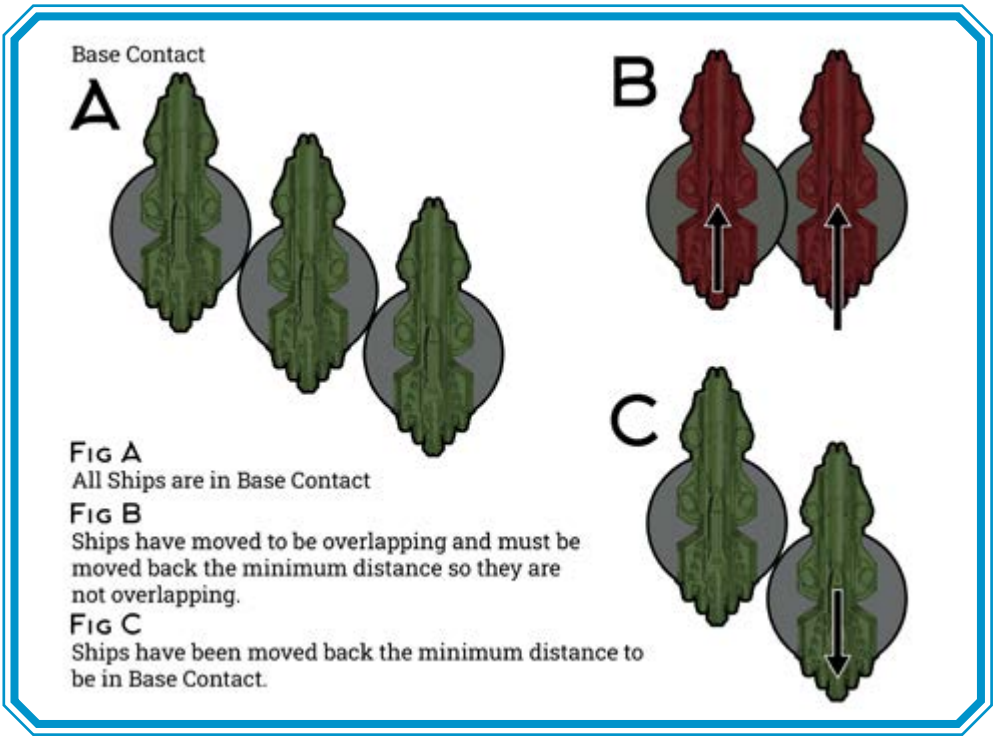


Fig A
All Ships are in Base Contact

Fig B
Ships have moved to be overlapping and must be moved back the minimum distance so they are not overlapping.

Fig C
Ships have been moved back the minimum distance to be in Base Contact.

Bases may be placed on top of tokens and most scenery. If you're using a 3D version of a token, substitute it for a 2D one if needed.

2.3.2 The Table

Dropfleet is played on a 48" x 48" gaming area referred to as the table. For particularly large or small games you may want to alter this size. You will likely need extra space for Ships yet to enter play, unused dice, stat cards, and other game components.

Unless otherwise specified, any Ship that moves off of the table during its activation counts as destroyed by each opponent, or captured by each opponent if it had any enemy battalions on it. If any Ship is moved off of the table outside of its activation, it counts as captured by each opponent. Ships allowed to fly off of the table may do so as described in that rule with no penalty.

2.3.3 Tokens

You will need various tokens to represent statuses, effects, Spikes, Features, Battalions, and Assets. If you use a non-standard token to represent anything, tell your opponent what it represents.

2.3.4 Dropsites

Dropsites are the Space Stations and Cities into which you can drop Battalions. Each Battalion token represents a ground force as seen in Dropzone Commander, but on a grand scale: around 300 troops plus armoured support.

Space Stations are 3D miniatures, while Cities are best represented in 2D since Ships can move over them. Capturing Dropsites is often vital, but they can be bombarded when capture is not an option or destruction is preferable. Dropsites can have destructible Features with special rules such as Weapons, scanners, and airfields.

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2.3.5 Scenery

Orbital space is often littered with the debris of past battles, planetary rings, asteroid fields, and moons. Practically, these are best represented in 2D since Ships can usually move over/through them. 3D and modelled versions can look great on the tabletop but make sure to have 2D substitutes on hand in case Ships end their moves in/over them.

3. Core Concepts

3.1 Orbital Layers

Dropfleet is played on two orbital layers: Orbit and Atmosphere. Certain Ships and Weapons act differently depending on the Orbital Layer they are in.

Ships may change Orbital Layer **only once during their activation** (though can still be forced to change Orbital Layer through other rules). They can either move down into Atmosphere from Orbit or move up from Atmosphere into Orbit.

3.1.1 Orbit

Groups begin the game in Orbit.

Ships in a Group may rise from Atmosphere into Orbit at the start of their movement—reduce the total movement each Ship in that Group may make for that action by 4". If this would reduce the Ship's movement to 0" then it cannot move from Atmosphere into Orbit.

3.1.2 Atmosphere

Ships in a Group may move from Orbit into Atmosphere at the end of their movement. Use a token to note which Ships have gone into Atmosphere.

Ships with the Descent special rule are designed to work in Atmosphere and are referred to as Descent Ships, which may be part of Descent Groups. The atmospheric operational depth of these Ships is far lower than normal ships.

3.1.2.1 Atmospheric Penalties

Ships have the following Atmospheric Penalties due to Atmosphere.

Drag

Ships in Atmosphere may move a maximum of 2".

Suboptimal Weapon

When attacking a City or a Descent Ship in Atmosphere, that attack always hits on a 6+ and can never cause a critical.

Innacurate

When attacking a **non-Descent Ship** in Atmosphere, reduce the lock of Weapons attacking it by 1.

Blind Shot

When attacking **into Orbit from Atmosphere**, any attack always hits on a 6+.

Buckling

A non-Descent Ship that ends its activation in Atmosphere takes D3 damage. Colossal Ships take 2D3 damage instead.

3.2 Ships

3.2.1 Groups

Ships are purchased for your fleet in Groups. The number of Ships allowed in one Group is dictated by the Group value on its profile (either a set number or a minimum and maximum value).

All Ships in a Group must be the same profile—like a Group of 2 Lysander Stealth Lighters. If the profile has options, all Ships in the Group must take the same options. Most big Ships have a Group value of 1—still a Group, but that Group is one Ship.

Ships in a Group perform their actions simultaneously. Sometimes for clarity you may want to perform some actions sequentially (like rolling for attacks), but remember to apply their effects as if they were simultaneous.

3.2.1.1 Lead Ships

At the start of a Group's activation, pick a Lead Ship. This is the Ship from which most measuring is done for this activation. **Lead Ships do not need to be the same each round**—you can choose different Lead Ships each time a Group activates. A Ship must be in Coherency to be chosen as a Lead Ship.

If no Ships in the Group are in Coherency, any may be chosen as the Lead Ship.

3.2.1.2 Coherency

All Coherency rules do not apply to Groups containing one Ship

A Group of Ships must remain in a **single** cohesive grouping to maintain Coherency. A Ship is in Coherency when it is within its Coherency range of another Ship in its Group. Ships in Groups of four or more must be within Coherency range of at least two other Ships in that Group to be in Coherency. **A Group cannot have more than one set of Ships in Coherency**. If it would, pick one set to be in Coherency. All other Ships in that Group are out of Coherency.

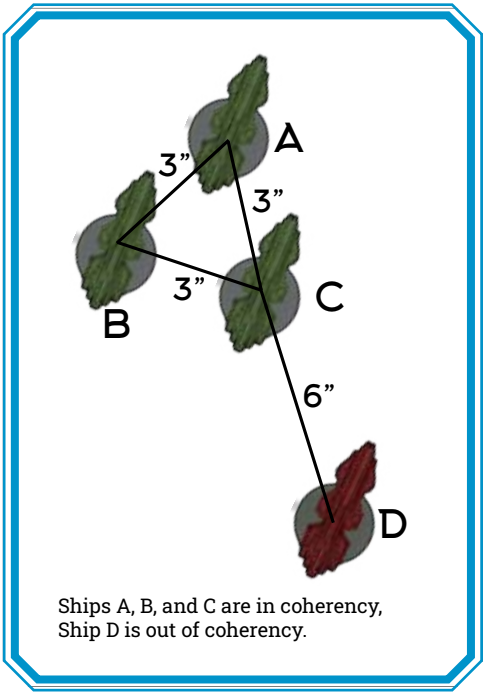
Ships of Light Tonnage have a Coherency of 3".

All other Ships have a Coherency of 6".

A Ship in a different orbital layer to its Group is out of Coherency.

If a Ship is out of Coherency, that Ship may not fire Weapons or launch Assets. If other Ships in its Group are in Coherency when it activates, it must move closer to the Lead Ship if possible, including moving into the same orbital layer as the Lead Ship.

You may not end a Group's movement with any Ships out of Coherency if it's possible not to.



Ships A, B, and C are in coherency, Ship D is out of coherency.

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3.2.1.3 Formation Benefits

If all the Ships in a Group of 2 or more Ships are in Coherency, the Group gains the following benefits:

- Any Crippling Effect rolls for Ships in this Group of a 10+ become a Structural Damage result instead. Crippling effects due to special rules are unaffected.
- It ignores the effects of Defence Systems Offline (individual Ships are still affected when targeted/affected individually).
- They gain an unmodifiable 6+ Backup Save against hits caused by attacks.
- They may measure Weapons range from the Group's Lead Ship (targets must still be in the attacking Ship's own arcs).
- They may Launch Assets from the Lead Ship instead of the launching Carrier.

3.2.2 Friendly and Enemy Ships

Ships in your fleet, as well as those of any teammates, are friendly Ships. Those belonging to your opponents are enemy Ships.

Certain effects and rules will specify either friendly or enemy Ships. Some rules may not specify either, in which case both can be affected.

3.3 Spikes

Spike tokens represent how much more visible a Group is due to the rigours of combat. Spikes are placed on Groups, and **each increases its Signature by 3".**

Groups may have up to 4 Spikes; any gained above this limit are lost.

Ships that track their own Spikes (sometimes due to special rules) may have up to 4 Spikes. Any gained above this limit are lost. If both a Ship and its Group have separate numbers of Spikes, only the highest is used.

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3.4 Arcs

Weapons only fire within certain arcs. These are listed on Weapon profiles and marked on the base by dividing lines.

When measuring to a **Ship**, if **that Ship's** stem is between two arcs, pick one for it to be in. It cannot be in both.

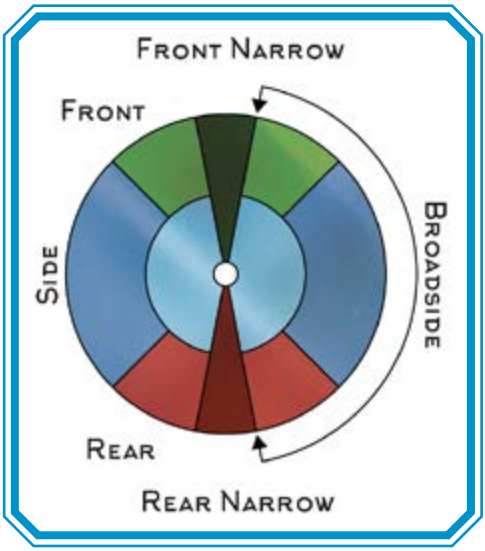
3.4.1 Front/Side/Rear (F/S/R)

Most Weapons use these arcs. Noted on Weapon profiles as F, S, and R, these are shown as 90-degree wedges measured outward from the base's stem. Side arcs are sometimes restricted to one side i.e. Side Left (SL) or Side Right (SR).

These arcs are also useful when determining how far a Ship can turn (as half of one of these arcs is 45 degrees).

3.4.2 Front/Rear Narrow (FN/RN)

Spinal-mounted Weapons use Front/Rear Narrow arcs. Noted on Weapon profiles as FN or RN, these are shown as a 22-degree wedge at the front/rear of the base measured outwards from the flight stem.



3.4.3 Broadside (B)

Side-mounted Broadside Weapons are noted on Weapon profiles as a B. Their arcs combine the entire S arc along with the segments of F and R arcs not covered by the FN and RN arcs. Broadside Arcs are separate arcs and sometimes restricted to either Left (BL) or Right (BR) sides."



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4. Preparation

4.1 Game Size

First, decide the game's size and points limit within the margins below. Each game size dictates the maximum number of Groups your Fleet may contain.

Skirmish: 501 – 1000 points. 16 Groups max.

Clash: 1001 – 2000 points. 20 Groups max.

Battle: 2001 – 3000 points. 24 Groups max.

Reconquest: 3001 points and above. 28 Groups max. For larger games, increase the max Groups by 4 for every 1000pts above 3001 (so 32 Groups in 5000pts).

4.2 Build Your Fleet

The combined points value of your Medium Tonnage Ships determines how many points of Light and Heavy Tonnage Ships you may include in your fleet. Depending on the points value of your taken Medium Ships and Game Size decided upon, you can include:

Tonnage	Restriction
Light	Up to the combined points of all your Medium Ships and Heavy Ships.
Heavy	No more points of Heavy and Colossal Ships than Medium Ships.
Colossal	Skirmish: 0 Groups. Clash: 1 Group total. Battle: 2 Groups total. Reconquest: 3 Groups total. No more points of Heavy and Colossal Ships than Medium Ships.

These restrictions are based upon the **total points** spent on Ships of those Tonnages.

Ships of Medium, Heavy, and Colossal Tonnage are referred to as Capital Ships.

4.2.1 Admirals

You may take any number of Admirals from the table below. Each Admiral's points cost contributes to your Fleet's total. Each faction also offers unique Faction and Famous Admirals—you may only take one of either of these.

Admiral Level	Points	Cannot be used in
2	20	-
3	40	Skirmish
4	60	Skirmish/Clash

Each Admiral must be assigned to a **Capital Ship** before each game. Famous Admirals must be assigned to the Ship in their profile. If their Ship is destroyed, that Admiral is killed and you cannot benefit from that Admiral's Level from then on.

Though your Fleet may include multiple Admirals, **only your highest-level Admiral present on the table counts towards any rules that specify one**—any Admirals not on the table are ignored.

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4.2.1.1 Abilities and Ability Points

Players can use Abilities to gain bonuses or cause havoc. These expend Ability Points (AP) to perform, which are generated during the game—better Admirals generate more AP. Unspent AP is lost at the end of each round.

Players have access to 4 core Abilities that have no restrictions on the number of times they may be used each round:

Cost	Effect
1AP	**AP Dice Bonus:** Once per Group, Asset, or Dropsite activation, or during the Repair step of the End Phase, after you roll any dice, you can add 1 to the result of one of those dice. This Ability cannot be used on D3s or dice results of a 1, and dice modified by this ability cannot score criticals.
1AP	**Brace for Impact:** After you roll for Crippling Effects, re-roll the Crippling Effect roll.
2AP	**Contain Reactor:** When a player would roll for Explosion, instead of rolling, make the result of an Explosion roll (for you or your opponent) a 2.
2AP	**Time to Target:** After moving a Wing of your Fighters or Bombers, you may move that Wing (or the Wing it combined into) a second time with a Thrust of 6" in any direction. The Wing cannot divide into smaller Wings or form/be formed into larger Wings due to this additional movement.

Each ability has a set trigger and its use can only be declared when this trigger is met (e.g. At the start of a Group's activation), before any other abilities are resolved. AP is expended when the ability is declared. Multiple abilities can be used on the same trigger, but each ability can only be used once per trigger. If multiple players use an ability on the same trigger, resolve these abilities in reverse initiative order with each player choosing the order their abilities resolve in.

4.2.1.2 Faction and Famous Admirals

Faction and Famous Admirals grant players additional Abilities. These may only be used once per triggering effect and only while their respective Admiral is on the table. If that Admiral is killed or leaves the table, any effects of previously used Abilities will continue and end as normal.

Famous Admirals also grant a bonus when they are included in your Fleet. These passive bonuses persist even if a Famous Admiral has been killed.

Faction and Famous Admirals adhere to the same restrictions on Game Size as found in 4.2.1 Admirals, with Level 5 Famous Admirals counting as a Level 4 Admiral for these purposes.

4.3 Choose a Scenario

Every military action has objectives, even if it's just killing the enemy. Scenarios define how the table should look, how your Ships approach it, how long the game is, and how to win.

Choose a Scenario before each game once players have built their Fleets—this avoids unbalanced Fleets designed to tackle a specific scenario.

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5. Game Rounds

Dropfleet is played over a number of rounds, with each split into phases. During a round, players must follow each phase and any steps within it in order. Once all phases have been completed, the game advances to the next round.

Planning Phase	Activation Phase	Asset Phase	End Phase
Ability Point Generation.	Players alternate activating Groups.	Battalion Combat.	Repair.
Pass Token Generation.	Players alternate activating Dropsites.	Boarding Actions.	Victory Points.
Determine Initiative.		Asset Combat.	Cleanup.

6. Planning Phase

1. Ability Point Generation
2. Pass Token Generation
3. Determine Initiative

6.1 Ability Point Generation

Players generate one Ability Point plus an amount equal to their Admiral's Level.

Some special rules may alter the amount of AP generated—apply these before generating your AP.

6.2 Pass Token Generation

Determine how many Groups each player has on the table + any that the Scenario states may deploy this turn. If a player has two fewer Groups than the player with the most, they generate a Pass token. For each additional Group fewer, they generate another Pass token.

Pass tokens do not persist after the Activation Phase.

6.3 Determine Initiative

Each player rolls a dice, the player with the highest score has 1st initiative, the 2nd highest has 2nd, and so on. The player with the highest-level Admiral on the table (or players if tied) adds 1 to the result of their dice.

This hierarchy remains until the next round, but the player with 1st initiative may choose to reverse this order for any phase at its beginning i.e., the player with 1st initiative can go last.

In the case of a tie, those players roll off again until a winner is determined.

The AP Re-roll ability cannot be used to re-roll any dice in your roll to determine initiative. Other abilities may still affect this roll.

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7. Activation Phase

The player with 1st initiative picks one of their Groups on the table or one allowed to deploy.

That player chooses an order for the activated Group. Orders are performed in the specified sequence, completing one action (moving, turning, attacking, etc) with the Group before moving on to the next action. Once that Group has completed its Order, the next player activates one of their Groups

Keep track of which Groups have been activated by using activation tokens.

A player may use a Pass token instead of activating a Group.

When you activate a Group off the table that can deploy this round, you may choose to have that Group remain off the table—that Group has still activated.

Once all Groups which may activate have done so, the Activation Phase is over.

7.1 Group's Orders

7.1.1 General Quarters

Remove two Spikes from the Group at the beginning of its activation.

The Group may turn up to 45 degrees and then must move between half and full Thrust.

Each Ship may attack with **up to half** of its listed Weapons rounded up (a Ship with three Weapons could fire two of them).

Each Ship may launch Assets at the end of its Group's activation.

7.1.2 Silent Running

Remove all Spikes from the Group at the beginning of its activation.

The Group may not turn and must move between half and full Thrust.

The Group **cannot attack** with any Weapons.

Each Ship may launch Assets at the end of its Group's activation. If it does not, reduce its Signature to 0" until its next activation.

7.1.3 Weapons Free

The Group cannot turn and must move between half and full Thrust.

Each Ship may attack **with any number** of its Weapon Systems.

Each Ship may then launch Assets, then the Group gains two Spikes at the end of its activation.

7.1.4 Course Change

The Group may turn up to 45 degrees, must move up to half its Thrust, then make an additional turn up to 45 degrees.

Each Ship may only attack with a **single** Weapon.

The Group may forgo one of its allowed turns (either the first or second) to launch Assets at the end of its activation.

The Group gains a Spike at the end of its activation.

7.1.5 Max Thrust

The Group may not turn and must move between full and twice its Thrust.

The Group **cannot attack** with any Weapons.

The Group gains two Spikes at the end of its activation and cannot launch Assets.

7.1.6 Damage Control

Each Ship recovers 1 lost Hull Point. Ships of H and C tonnage recover D3 lost Hull Points instead.

The Group may turn up to 45 degrees, then must move up to half its Thrust.

Each Ship may only attack with a **single Close Action** Weapon.

The Group may not Launch Assets.

At the end of this Group's activation, it rolls to repair as if it was the Repair step of the End Phase, then attempts to repel boarders. Roll either a Backup save or a roll of a 6+ for each enemy Battalion aboard each Ship in the Group and remove an enemy Battalion from that Ship for each successful dice

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7.2 Move

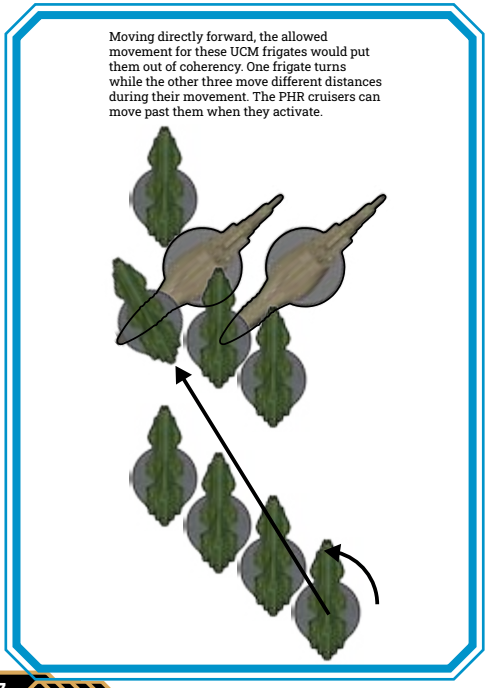
Ships move straight forward a number of inches dependant on that Ship's Thrust, selected Order, and other modifiers to movement and Thrust.

When turning, a Ship pivots around it's base's stem.

Ships move and turn individually.

Ships may move through other Ships, tokens, and most scenery, but cannot end their move with their base overlapping any other base. Where possible, a Ship must move to within the specified movement distances stated by its order. If a Ship cannot be placed anywhere between these distances due to bases overlapping, it is placed the minimum available distance from its starting position so that bases are not overlapping along its line of movement.

A Ship that must move due to an order but chooses to move 0" (such as the Course Change order) during its movement counts as having moved.



Moving directly forward, the allowed movement for these UCM frigates would put them out of coherency. One frigate turns while the other three move different distances during their movement. The PHR cruisers can move past them when they activate.

7.3 Attack

Whenever you Attack, follow this sequence:

1. Determine potential targets.
2. Assign Weapons to targets.
3. Roll to Hit.
4. Roll to Save.
5. Inflict Damage.
6. Roll for Crippling Effects.
7. Roll for Explosions.

NB: Since players may pre-measure, steps 1 and 2 are completed simultaneously

7.3.1 Determine Potential Targets

Unless otherwise specified, **potential targets must be either:**

- An enemy Group.
- A Dropsite you do not Control.

Potential targets must be in range. A Weapon's range is equal to the Scan value of the attacking Ship plus the target's Signature, measured from the attacking Ship.

Potential targets must be visible. Draw a straight line between the attacking Ship and any Ship in the target Group or centre point of the target Dropsite.

If the line does not pass through any scenery (see the Scenery section for more info) the attacking Ship has line of sight. If that line passes through any scenery, the Weapon's range may be reduced, or the Ship may not have Line of Sight at all.

Ships, Space Stations, and Cities do not affect Line of Sight.

Potential targets must lie within a Weapon's arc, measured from the attacking Ship.

Only one Ship in a Group needs to be targeted to target that Group. Range and line of sight are ignored for its other Ships.

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7.3.2 Assign Weapons to Targets

Weapons you are attacking with must be assigned to a potential target. Pick a Weapon and a potential target to assign it to. Some Ship or Weapon special rules may affect how a Weapon is assigned.

Any Ship/set of Ships out of coherency must be targeted as if it/they were a separate Group.

You must assign a target to every Weapon a Group is attacking with before rolling any dice.

7.3.3 Roll to Hit

Some Weapons may have a random Attack value—roll this before rolling to hit.

Roll the attack dice for each Weapon. Each result of at least the Weapon's Lock value is a hit. **Each result of at least 2 higher than the Weapon's Lock value is also a critical.** A critical does nothing on its own, but some special rules interact with them for a variety of effects.

Any dice that rolls lower than its Lock value is a miss.

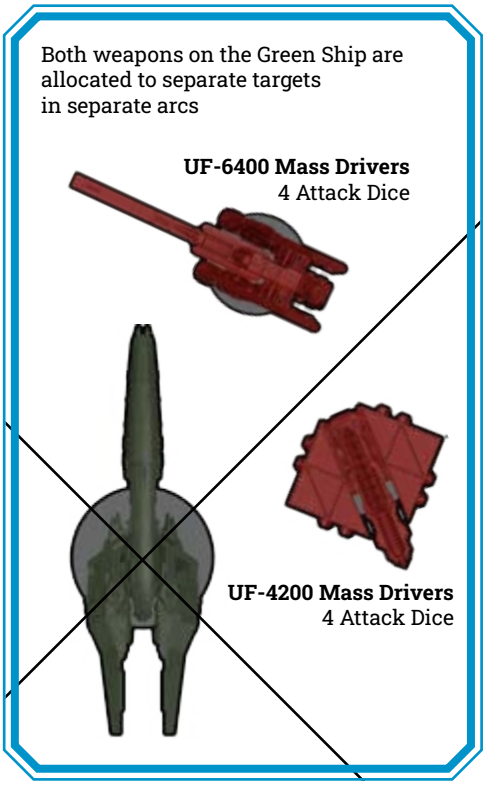
Roll to hit with all assigned weapons before your opponent rolls to save.

It may be useful to roll attacks with identical Weapons with the same target simultaneously. If an individual Ship's attacks are modified in any way, roll these attacks separately.

7.3.4 Roll to Save

The defender (or an opponent for uncontrolled/uncontested Dropsites) rolls a dice for each hit using the corresponding save value. For each roll of at least the target's save value, **reduce the amount of hits by 1**. If the target has a Backup save, it may then attempt to block any remaining hits in the same way.

Weapons have a Damage Type which dictates what defences can be used against it:



Energy Weapons (E) hits can be prevented through Energy Saves then Backup saves.

Kinetic Weapons (K) hits can be prevented through Kinetic Saves then Backup saves.

Core Weapons (C) hits can only be prevented by Shield saves (if applicable) then Backup saves.

It may be useful to roll saves against identical Weapons simultaneously. If a Weapon's hits are modified in any way, roll these attacks separately in an order chosen by the attacking player.

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7.3.5 Inflict Damage

After the defending player rolls to save, allocate the remaining hits to Ships in the defending Group. Starting with the hits with the greatest damage, allocate these hits to the Ship with the least remaining Hull Points until there is enough damage from those hits to destroy it. Any damage from hits beyond a Ship's remaining Hull Points are lost. Then continue allocating hits this way to the next Ship with the least remaining Hull Points and so on. If all remaining Ships are undamaged or equally damaged, allocate from the closest Ship to the attacking Group's Lead Ship to the furthest.

Damage reduces a Ship's total Hull. If a Ship is reduced to 0 Hull, it is destroyed and removed from play.

Allocate all damage from the Group's Weapon attacks before rolling for Crippling Effects.

Damage cannot be blocked by saves—only hits can.

Allocate all hits before rolling for Crippling Effects.

7.3.6 Roll for Crippling Effects

The first time any damage reduces a Capital Ship to below half of its starting Hull value, it suffers a Crippling Effect. The defending player rolls 2D6 and consults the table below. Apply the specified effect to that Ship. **Each Ship is only affected by this roll once, regardless of the number of times it would be reduced below half of its starting Hull Value.**

Except for Fire, a Ship may only have one of each type of Crippling Effect at a time (Spikes are not a Crippling Effect). Any duplicate Crippling Effects are ignored.

Repairable Crippling Effects may be repaired during the End Phase.

Result	Crippling Effect
2-3	**Energy Surge:** Gain a Spike.
4-5	**Structural Damage:** Suffer another point of damage.
6	**Fire:** Gain a Fire Token. At the start of the End Phase, before the Repair step, this ship suffers a point of damage for each Fire Token it has. Repairable. This effect is repaired on a roll of a 3+ instead of a 4+.
7	**Defence Systems Offline:** Gain a Defence Systems Offline Token. A Ship with a Defence Systems Offline token reduces its Energy, Kinetic, Backup, and Shield saves by 1, and may be targeted by enemy Ships as if their weapons had the Focused special rule, ignoring Formation Benefits if they do. Repairable.
8	**Scanners Offline:** Gain a Scanners Offline token, reducing this Ship's Scan to 1". Repairable.
9	**Weapons Offline:** Gain a Weapons Offline token, preventing this Ship from using Weapons or launching Assets. Repairable.
10	**Navigation Offline:** Gain a Navigation Offline token, reducing this Ship's total movement to 2" (regardless of Thrust) and preventing it from turning or changing Orbital Layer. Repairable.
11+	**Orbital Decay:** The Ship gains an Orbital Decay token and falls into Atmosphere. Orbital Decay tokens prevent this Ship from moving from Atmosphere into Orbit. Repairable. This effect is repaired on a roll of a 5+ instead of a 4+.

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7.3.7 Roll for Explosion

When a Capital Ship is destroyed by an attack, Crippling effect (including the resulting damage from one), or explosion effect it explodes. The defending player rolls 1D6 and consults the table below. Apply the result to the Ship. Heavy Ships add 1 to their result. Colossal Ships add 2 to their result.

Medium Ships explode with a range of 3".

Heavy Ships explode with a range of 6".

Colossal Ships explode with a range of 9".

If multiple Ships explode simultaneously (generally due to multiple Weapon attacks from the same Group), resolve them sequentially in a random order.

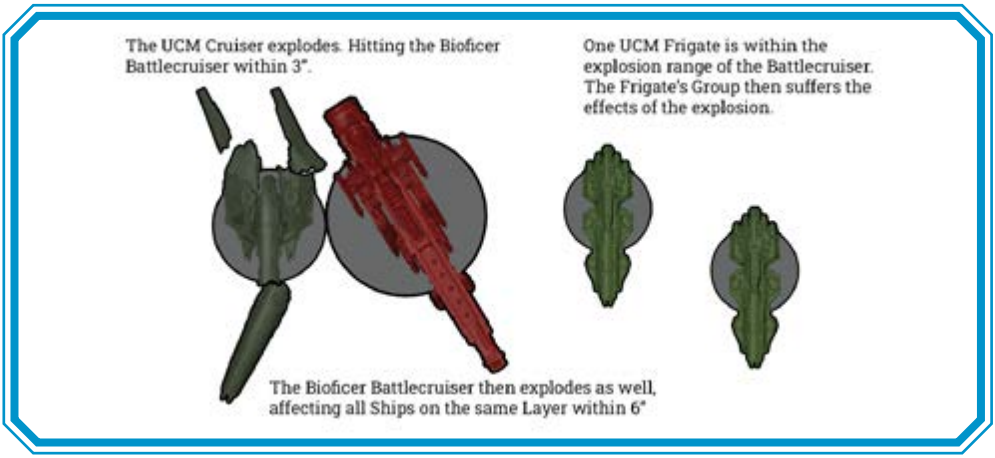
Hits and damage caused by explosions are resolved as if they were caused by an attack (counting the exploding Ship as Lead Ship if required).

Explosions only affect the Orbital Layer the exploding Ship is in.

Fighters and Bombers are affected by explosions individually. Roll for each affected Asset in a Wing before moving onto the next Wing.

Battalions are unaffected by the initial explosion effect.

Result	Explosion Effect
1	**Burn Up:** The exploding Ship is removed from play with no further effects.
2	**Reactor Rupture:** All Groups and Space Stations within double the explosion range gain a Spike.
3	**Shredded:** All Groups and Space Stations in explosion range suffer 3 Kinetic hits. Assets are removed on a 5+.
4	**Fuel Detonation:** All Groups and Space Stations in explosion range suffer 3 Energy hits. Assets are removed on a 4+.
5	**Reactor Overload:** All Groups and Space Stations in explosion range suffer 3 Core hits. Assets are removed on a 3+.
6+	**Foldspace Catastrophe:** All Groups and Space Stations in explosion range suffer 4 damage and gain a Spike. Assets are removed on a 2+.



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7.4 Launch Assets

Assets are small craft launched from Carriers. Most Assets require 20x20mm tokens. Each represents a squadron of Fighters/Bombers or a single Torpedo/Mine, although 1 token is the smallest possible unit and is sometimes referred to in the singular i,e. 'Fighter' means one token.

All Groups and Dropsites which can launch Assets (shown in their profile) are Carriers. Carriers may launch Assets during their activations if/when allowed by their Orders.

Unless otherwise stated, when you launch Assets, place those Assets up to their Launch Value within 6" of their Carrier, divided up as you wish. This placement counts as moving through scenery when placed through or onto scenery.

Each Carrier in a Group contributes its own Assets but does not have to combine them with the rest of its Group when they launch Assets and can place them separately.

When a carrier's load is shared between two different types of Launch Asset (e.g. Fighters & Bombers) you can choose any combination of those Assets to place when launching Assets, up to their Launch value.

7.4.1 Deploying Battalions

Battalions are deployed by launching their associated Asset. Each of these have different targets for their Batallions. **These resolve immediately** so do not need tokens—place 1 Battalion on their target for each Asset being launched at it. These Assets may only be launched at targets within their range, measured from the launching Carrier.

When you deploy Battalions to Dropsites, you may instead deploy them to a specific Feature on that Dropsite, dividing the total Battalions deployed as you choose between Dropsite and Feature.

Type	Target	Range
Bulk Landers	Dropsites on any orbital layer. If that Dropsite or its Features have enemy Battalions on them, 2 Bulk Landers are needed to place 1 Batallion.	6"
Dropships	Dropsites on the same orbital layer.	3"
Boarding Pods	Space Stations and enemy Ships in the same Orbital Layer.	3"
Drop Pods	Cities.	3"

7.4.2 Deploying Features

Some Ships carry Deployable Features. These Ships are counted as carriers and may deploy their carried features onto Dropsites. These are launched in the same way as other Assets, at a range of 6", and on any orbital layer. Place the Feature miniature/token on the Dropsite. Once deployed, it becomes a Feature and cannot move.

7.4.3 Immediate Combat

After launching Assets, if any of those Assets were placed directly into base contact with specific targets, you may attack with those Assets immediately instead of during the Asset Phase. If the following conditions are met, the launched asset immediately attacks, using the rules for attacking with that asset (see 8.3 Asset Combat):

- Fighters launched into base contact with enemy Fighters or Bombers
- Bombers launched into base contact with Space Stations or enemy Ships
- Torpedoes launched into base contact with Space Stations or enemy Ships"

7.4.5 Recall Launch

If launching a Fighter or Bomber would bring you above your Launch Capacity, you may remove friendly Fighters/Bombers from the table until you would be at your Launch Capacity.

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8. Asset Phase

1. Battalion Combat.
2. Boarding Actions.
3. Asset Combat.

8.1 Battalion Combat

Each Dropsite with Battalions belonging to 2 or more players and has not had Battalion Combat resolve this round is eligible for Battalion Combat. In initiative order, each player selects an eligible Dropsite to resolve combat on before moving on to the next. Repeat this until there are no more eligible Dropsites.

After a player selects a Dropsite to resolve, players follow this sequence to assign combat to Battalions:

1. Dropsite to Feature Combat

In initiative order, each player with Battalions assigned to the Dropsite may select a single one of its Features with opposing Battalions on it. In the same order, players remove equal amounts of Battalions from their Battalions assigned to the Dropsite and their chosen Feature until either no player, or only one player has Battalions remaining in that combat.

2. Dropsite Centric Combat

Each player with Battalions assigned to the Dropsite removes equal amounts of Battalions from it until either no player, or only one player has Battalions remaining in that combat.

3. Feature Centric Combat

For each Feature on the Dropsite, each player with Battalions on it removes equal amounts of Battalions until either no player, or only one player has Battalions remaining in that combat.

4. Feature Demolition

Players with an amount of friendly Battalions on a Feature equal to or greater than that Feature's remaining Hull that also contains no enemy Battalions may remove all of those Battalions to destroy that Feature.

5. Battalion Consolidation

Players may now consolidate Battalions they have anywhere on the Dropsite. If they do, they choose any amount of those Battalions and assign them to the Dropsite (any amount can be 0), then assign any remaining Battalions to a single Feature on the Dropsite.

When Battalions are removed in each step of Battalion Combat, they are removed simultaneously.

When a player has multiple types of Battalions in a combat, that player decides which of their Battalions are removed first. If players are allied, treat their Battalions as belonging to one player and decide with your ally/s whose Battalions to remove.



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8.1.1 Activating Dropsites

After players have completed Battalion Combat for a Dropsite, a player that controls that Dropsite, **ignoring enemy deployed Features**, activates it. For each Scenario Feature only they have Battalions on, they may attack with all its Weapons and/or launch all available Assets. Scenario Features containing enemy Battalions or Features deployed by other players cannot be used to attack or launch this way.

Then, in initiative order, **each player** may activate all deployable Features they have on the Dropsite. Each Feature may attack with all its weapons and/or launch Assets.

Deployed Features with **only** enemy Battalions assigned to them cannot be activated and lose all of their special rules (though still confer their saves to the Dropsite) until they have an equal amount of, or more friendly Battalions assigned to them.

8.2 Boarding Actions

Each Ship with Battalions belonging to an opponent and has not had Boarding Actions resolve this round is eligible for Boarding Actions. In initiative order, each player selects an eligible Ship with enemy Battalions on to resolve Boarding Actions before moving on to the next. Repeat this until there are no more eligible Ships.

Each player with Battalions on the Ship removes equal amounts of Battalions until either no player, or only one player has Battalions remaining.

Then, each friendly Battalion left aboard an enemy Ship inflicts a Core hit. Total these up before rolling backup saves. Each passed backup save also removes one Battalion. If the Ship is destroyed by the boarders, remove it from play without rolling for Explosion—that Ship is captured. At the end of the game, when determining points of Ships destroyed, captured Ships count towards this and are worth double their points.

If a carrier with Assets that deploy Battalions does not launch any of those assets this round, choose one of those Assets types. For each of the chosen Assets, this carrier removes an enemy Battalion on it before any Core hits are inflicted.

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8.3 Asset Combat

Except Mines, Assets which persist after launching activate now in this order:

1. Fighters.
2. Bombers.
3. Torpedoes.

The player with 1st initiative activates all their Fighter Assets, then the player with 2nd, and so on. Once all Fighters have been activated, players advance to Bombers, and so on.

8.3.1 Moving Assets

Assets move in a straight line up to their Thrust, but their facing is irrelevant so can move in any direction. They ignore orbital layers but count as moving in Orbit for Scenery purposes.

8.3.2 Wings

A Wing is multiple, identical Fighter or Bomber Assets flying together for protection and potency. When you launch Fighters or Bombers, you may divide them into as many Wings as you wish—use one token for each Wing with dice beside it to show the number of tokens.

Wings may divide into any number of smaller wings as part of their activation during that particular Asset's Form Wings step. A single Fighter/Bomber Asset is still a Wing. When you divide a Wing, place all new Wings in base contact with the original.

When you Form Wings, you can combine identical Assets in base contact into a single larger Wing. If you do, choose one of those Wings for the rest to be combined with. If any assets in a newly formed Wing have moved, all assets in that Wing are treated as having moved.

Each Fighter/Bomber can only form or divide into Wings once each round and cannot do both.

If a Wing ends its move in base contact with any of your other, identical Fighters/Bombers, you may form them into a single Wing.

8.3.3 Activating Fighters

When a player activates Fighters, follow these steps in order:

A. Form Wings

B. Fighter Movement

C. Fighter Attacks

Assets perform each step simultaneously; form all Wings before moving and move all Wings before attacking.

8.3.3.a Form Wings

During this step, you may form your Fighters into Wings and divide into Wings.

8.3.3.b Fighter Movement

For each of your Fighter Wings, move them in a straight line up to their Thrust value in any direction.

8.3.3.c Fighter Attacks

Fighters in base contact with an enemy Fighter or Bomber Wing may attack one of those Wings. Declare the use of all Fighters you wish to attack with before proceeding.

If attacking a Bomber Wing, remove the attacking Fighters and defending Bombers equally until only one of those Wings remains.

If attacking a Fighter Wing, remove all the Fighters in the smaller Wing and the same number of Fighters in the larger.

Once all their attacks have been resolved, the Fighter's activation is over. Any remaining Fighters can activate again in the next round

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8.3.3.1 Fighters—Close Protection

After rolling Kinetic or Energy saves against Close Action and Bomber (of any type) attacks, you may declare the use of any number of Fighters. Each Fighter used confers its re-rolls to a defending friendly Group within its Thrust range. The **defending player assigns all re-rolls** from each Fighter against specific weapons, dividing up Fighters as they choose. Shield and Backup saves cannot be re-rolled this way.

Once a Fighter has been used in this way, remove it.

Fighters cannot be used this way if there is scenery between them and any Ships in the defending Group.

8.3.4 Activating Bombers

When a player activates Bombers, follow these steps in order

A. Form Wings

B. Bomber Movement

C. Bomber Attacks

D. Remove Attackers

Assets perform each step simultaneously; form all Wings before moving and move all Wings before attacking.

8.3.4.a Form Wings

During this step, you may form your Bombers into Wings and divide into Wings.

8.3.4.b Bomber Movement

For each of your Bomber Wings, move them in a straight line up to their Thrust value in any direction.

8.3.4.c Bomber Attacks

Bombers in base contact with a Ship or Space Station may be used to attack that Ship or Space Station. Bombers cannot attack a Space Station with friendly Battalions or friendly Ships. Only Bombers with the Bombardment special rule may attack Descent Groups in Atmosphere or Cities, treating its template as a base. When you attack with a Wing, All Bombers in that Wing contribute to the attack. Declare the use of all Bombers you wish to attack with before proceeding.

Declare all Bomber attacks before rolling any dice.

Bombers attack as if they were a weapon with the stats in their profile, following the attack sequence from 7.3.3 Roll to Hit onwards. **Each type of Bomber attacking the same target combines into a single roll for that type of Bomber**, counting as a separate Weapon System.

Damage from a Wing is only allocated to the Ship it attacked. Any excess damage from the attack is lost.

8.3.4.d Remove Attackers

After completing an attack with Bombers, remove the attacking Bombers from play.

8.3.4.1 Fire Ships

Fire Ships are a type of Bomber and follow the above rules for Activating Bombers.

8.3.4.2 Saturation Fire

Each type of Bomber attacking a Light Ship, or Crippled Capital Ship gains Saturation Fire against the target. After rolling to hit, for every Bomber above 6 in an attack, one hit of the attacker's choice for that type of Bomber becomes Core damage rather than Kinetic or Energy damage

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8.3.5 Activating Torpedoes

First, move your Torpedoes in a straight line in any direction up to their Thrust.

They may then attack any Ship or Space Station they are in base contact with. **Only Torpedoes with the Bombardment special rule may attack Cities or attack Descent Groups in Atmosphere**. Torpedoes attack as if they were a Weapon with the stats in their profile. **Torpedoes can only damage the attacked Ship**. Declare the use of all Torpedoes you wish to attack with before proceeding.

When a Torpedo attacks, remove the attacking Torpedo from play after completing the attack.

8.3.5.1 Shooting Down Torpedoes

Weapons in Orbit and Escape Velocity weapons in Atmosphere may be assigned to Torpedoes. Torpedoes have a Signature of 0" and never have saves of any kind. Instead of inflicting damage, each hit against a torpedo reduces the Torpedo's Attack value by 1. If a Torpedo has its Attack value reduced to 0 this way, the Torpedo is removed.

When you attack a Torpedo this way, that attack always hits on a 6+.

8.3.6 Mines

Mines cannot move or be moved once launched. Instead, whenever an enemy Ship in Orbit moves through a Mine's Thrust, you may have that Mine attack that Ship.

Mines attack as if they were a weapon with the stats in their profile. Every Mine attacking the same target combines into one roll. Remove a Mine after completing an attack with it. Roll for this attack when the Ship completes its movement, choosing a point within the Mine's Thrust as the enemy Ship's position and Orbital Layer for this attack, even if it ends its movement out of range and on a different Orbital Layer. Use this point for any explosion effects due to this attack. **Mines can only damage the attacked Ship.**

Mines may be used against torpedoes that move through the Mines' Thrust. Mines used this way ignore the penalties for attacking Torpedoes.

8.3.6.1 Clearing Mines

Weapons in Orbit and Weapons with the Escape Velocity special rule may be assigned to Mines. Mines have a Signature of 0" and never have saves of any kind. Instead of inflicting damage, each hit against a Mine reduces the Mine's Attack value by 1. If a Mine has its Attack value reduced to 0 this way, the Mine is removed.

When you attack a Mine this way, that attack always hits on a 6+.

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9. End Phase

9.1 Repair

During this step, you may attempt a repair roll for each repairable Crippling Effect on friendly Ships. To make a repair roll, roll 1D6. If the result is a 4+, that Crippling Effect is removed, otherwise, the Crippling Effect remains

9.2 Victory Points

Victory Points are calculated during this step according to the scoring methods detailed in each scenario.

9.3 Cleanup

Players remove all Activation tokens from their Groups and resolve any effects that last until "the end of the round". Once the Cleanup step is complete, the round is over.

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10. Scenery

While there's a lot of space above planets, Orbit can quickly become a dangerous place, with debris both large and small wreaking havoc on Ships travelling through it. While a lot of it burns up once it hits atmosphere, consideration must be given to avoid it while in Orbit.

Scenery only affects Ships, Space Stations, and Assets in Orbit.

Scenery affects Line of Sight (including in 7.3.1 Determine Potential Targets) unless both ends of the line are in Atmosphere.

Unless stated, Scenery can be moved through and attacked through – meaning into, out of, or all the way through. When attacking through scenery, apply any relevant effects of that scenery unless both the attacker and the target are in Atmosphere.

Scenery pieces of the same type that are overlapping count as the same scenery piece for movement and attacks.

When placing scenery, it must be placed at least 4" away from board edges, deployment zones, other scenery pieces, and Dropsites unless otherwise specified.

Scenarios will define which of these types to use:

10.1 Planetary Ring

Planetary rings are ice, dust, and pebbles encircling a planet. They are represented by a line with no thickness that runs across the table.

Groups and Dropsites on one side of a Planetary Ring Ignore two Spikes on targets on the other side of the Planetary Ring if those targets are further than 3" away from the Planetary Ring. If the target is on the other side of the Planetary Ring and further than 6" away from it, ignore all of its Spikes instead."

Each Asset moved through this is removed on a 3+. Battalions deploying to Dropsites directly under a Planetary Ring are ignored.

10.2 Micrometeor Cloud

These are usually areas of micrometeors or the remnants of annihilated spacecraft. They typically measure around 6" by 3" but can be much larger.

Ignore the target's Spikes when attacking through Micrometeor Clouds.

Each Ship moved through this suffers 2 Kinetic hits.

After you move or place assets into or through this, roll a dice. For each result of a 3+, remove one of those assets.

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10.3 Debris Field

These are usually chaotic expanses of tumbling chunks, from asteroids to shipwrecks. Occasionally, one might represent the scaffolding matrix of orbital shipyards. These typically measure around 6" by 3".

Ignore the target's Spikes and Signature when attacking through Dense Fields.

Each Ship moved through this suffers 2 Core hits.

After you move or place assets into or through this, roll a dice. For each result of a 5+, remove one of those assets.

10.4 Large Objects

These are moons, massive asteroids, or even orbital plates—vast instillations only seen over densely developed worlds. They are usually circular and 6-12" in diameter.

These block Line of Sight. If any Ship or Asset is placed or moved onto a Large Object, it is destroyed.

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11. Dropsites

Dropsites are strategic locations that often must be Controlled or destroyed. **They are either Space Stations, which exist in Orbit, or Cities, which exist in Atmosphere**.

Dropsites cannot be moved or turned. Space Station bases cannot be moved onto, as if they were Ships. Cities have a base the size of their template. Bases of Cities are ignored when moving and are moved over as if they were not there.

Most Scenarios will specify a standard size for each Dropsite. Each size of Dropsite has a corresponding physical size. Space Stations use the same bases as Light, Medium, and Heavy Ships for Small, Medium, and Large Space Stations respectively. Cities use templates of a specific size, denoting Small, Medium, and Large Cities.

Icon	Dropsite	Scan	Sig	Hull	ES	KS
S	Small Space Station	6"	4"	10	4+	4+
M	Medium Space Station	6"	6"	15	4+	4+
L	Large Space Station	6"	8"	25	4+	4+
	Small City	6"	0"	10	5+	5+
	Medium City	6"	0"	15	5+	5+
	Large City	6"	0"	25	5+	5+

11.1 Control & Contest

Players Control a Dropsite if **only they** have Battalions and/or any Features they have deployed on it. If only allied players have Battalions/deployed Features on it, those players must choose who Controls it.

Players Contest a Dropsite if **they and an opponent** have Battalions and/or deployed Features on it.

Players that destroy a Dropsite have **Levelled** it.

Dropsites that have less than half of their Hull Points remaining are **Ruined**.

11.2 Damaging Dropsites

Dropsites use the best Save available out of those on their Features (so a Dropsite with a Military Outpost has an Energy Save of 3+). Once a feature has been removed, any saves that feature would grant cannot be used.

When a Dropsite has been reduced to 0 Hull Points, it is destroyed. Remove all Battalions from that Dropsite. If that Dropsite is a Space Station, remove it from the board. Destroyed Dropsites cannot have assets assigned to them and all Features on them are removed and do not count for any scoring.

11.2.1 Collateral Damage

Whenever a Dropsite loses a Hull Point, each player removes that many of their Battalions from the Dropsite. If any Battalions are deployed to Features, remove those before removing Battalions assigned to the Dropsite.

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11.3 Features

Features are distinct elements of a Dropsite. They provide a Dropsite with rules and are represented by tokens or removable parts of a Space Station miniature. Dropsites can gain Features according to the scenario and they can be removed from Dropsites during the game due to damage.



	Type	ES	KS	Hull	Special
◆	Military Outpost	3+	3+	6	-

Weapon	Scan	Att	Lock	Dmg	Type	Special
Missile Halo	6"	1	2+	2	K	Close Action, Escape Velocity

	Type	ES	KS	Hull	Special
■	Orbital Defence Gun	5+	5+	5	-

Weapon	Scan	Att	Lock	Dmg	Type	Special
Orbital Gun	6"	3	3+	1	E	Burnthrough-1, Escape Velocity

	Type	ES	KS	Hull	Special
○	Comms Station	4+	4+	5	**Comms Uplink:** If you control this Dropsite, increase the amount of Ability Points you generate by 1. You can only be affected by Comms Uplink once each round.

	Type	ES	KS	Hull	Special
⚡	Power Plant	5+	5+	5	**Volatile:** When this Feature is destroyed, all Groups within 3" gain a Spike and this Feature's Dropsite takes an additional 2D3 damage.

	Type	ES	KS	Hull	Special
▲	Hangar	4+	4+		-

Type	Launch	Special
Fighters & Bombers*	2	-

*This Feature's Fighters & Bombers use the Controlling players' Fighters & Bombers.

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11.3.1 Damaging Features

When you assign weapons to a Space Station or Bombardment weapons to a City, you may choose to assign any amount of those weapons to Features on that Dropsite instead of the Dropsite. Abilities and Special rules treat this weapon as targeting the Dropsite. If you do, use the saves of those Features instead of the Dropsite. Damage inflicted to features is tracked independently of the Dropsite. When a Feature is reduced to 0 hull points, that Feature is destroyed and is removed from the dropsite, along with all battalions assigned to that feature. Any remaining damage is ignored. **Deployable Features that have an associated points cost** count as Ships when determining Kill Points at the end of the game.

When an Attack targets both a Dropsite and a Feature on that Dropsite, battalions are removed from damage to or destruction of Features first. Then remove battalions for damage dealt to the Dropsite itself as normal.

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12. Scenarios

12.1 Generating Scenarios

Scenarios are generated using several tables with random results, providing players with a way to make a different scenario from core blocks each game.

Tables will use a D6 to determine the results. To generate a scenario, roll once for each table in order. Follow the results of each roll to determine each aspect of the Scenario.

Scenarios Generated using this method have a game length of 6 rounds. Once the 6th round has been completed, the game is over and a winner is determined by the players' accumulated Victory Points.

NB: Generated scenarios are designed to be used with a 4' x 4' table.

You can also choose from these options to generate scenarios based on personal preference. To emphasise the ground combat part of the game, build a scenario around Atmospheric deployment. If you prefer a pure space battle, design your scenarios around Orbital Complexes and avoid Atmosphere altogether.

12.1.1 Deployment Type

Roll a D6 to determine the Deployment Type. Re-roll results of 5 or 6 for competitive games. Next, dice off to determine which deployment zone each player will use. Allies may share a deployment zone if all players agree

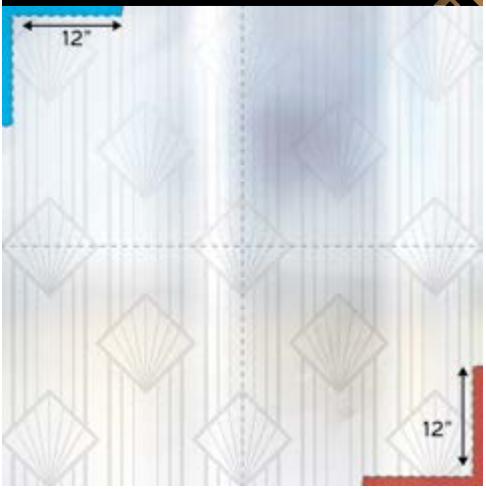
1 – Line



2 Players: All Ships in base contact with opposite table edges as shown.

3-4 Players: All Ships in base contact with a single table edge for each player.

2 – Table Corners

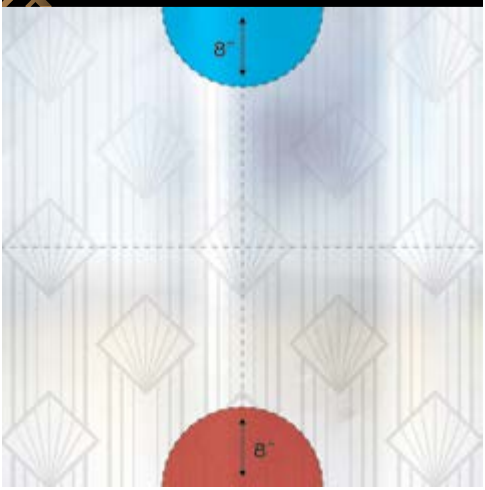


2 Players: All Ships in base contact with a table edge up to 12" from opposite corners.

3-4 Players: All Ships in base contact with a table edge up to 12" from a single corner for each player.

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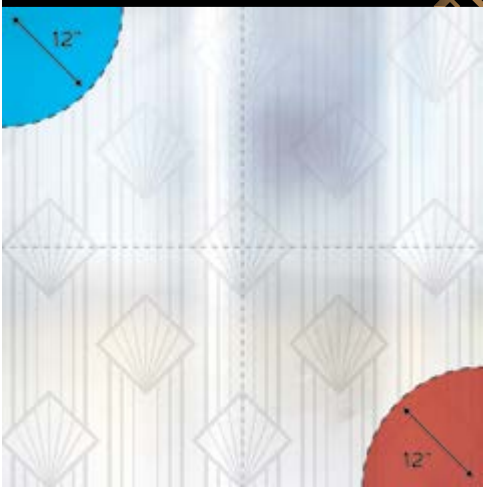
3 – Midboard



2 Players: 8" from the centre of opposite table edges.

3-4 Players: 8" from the centre of separate table edges.

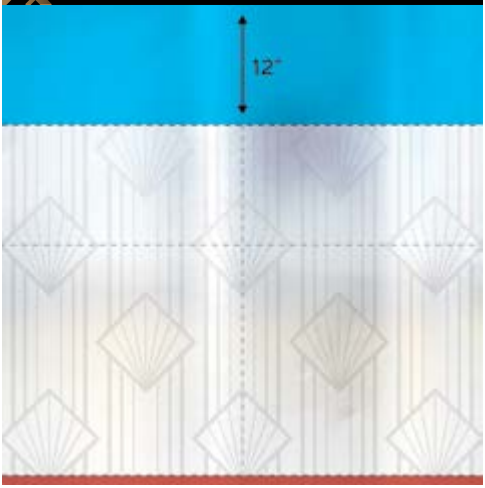
4 – From Corners



2 Players: 12" from opposite table corners.

3-4 Players: 12" from separate table corners.

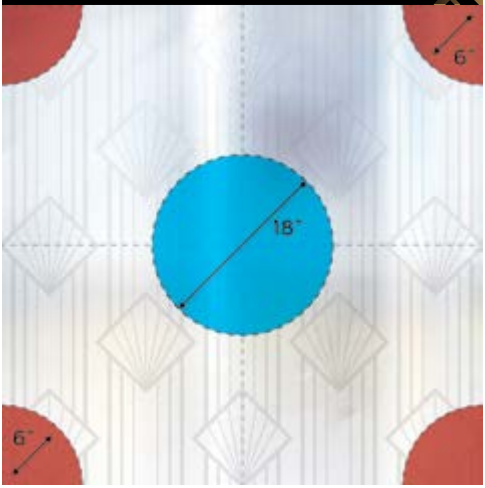
5 – Attacker Defender



1 Attacking Team in Red with all Ships in base contact with the table edge as shown.

1 Defending Team in Blue 12" from the opposite table edge.

6 – Encirclement



1 Attacking Team in Red 6" from all board corners.

1 Defending Team in Blue 9" from the board centre.

Scenario rules and Objectives that require you to measure distance from these Deployment Zones to a Dropsite reduce that distance by half.

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12.1.2 Approach Type

When you activate and deploy a Group not on the table, it must be deployed before it can do anything. When Groups deploy, unless otherwise specified they are placed with flight stems within your specified deployment zone, with **all Ships in Coherency** in your deployment zone (so no Ship is outside of the deployment zone or Coherency) when they activate. Once a Group has been deployed it continues its activation as normal.

If a Group is unable to fit completely within your deployment zone when it deploys, that Group instead remains off of the table until the next time it would be able to deploy, following its Approach Type. Any Groups that have not been deployed by the end of the game count as destroyed

Roll a D6 to determine Approach Type. Re-roll results of 4, 5, or 6 for competitive games.

12.1.2.1 Directly Deployed

Players that Directly Deploy must place at least 50% of their Groups within their Deployment Zone before the start of the 1st round. If multiple players must Directly Deploy, all red players deploy these Groups, then all blue players deploy these Groups. Groups not deployed cannot be activated during the 1st round. From the 2nd round onwards, players that Directly Deploy may activate Groups not on the table.

12.1.2.2 Close

Players using Close Deployment may activate and deploy any of their Groups that are not on the table from the start of the 1st round.

12.1.2.3 Distant

Players using Distant Deployment may only activate and deploy Groups with L tonnage in the 1st round. From the start of the 2nd round onwards, they may also activate groups of M tonnage. From the start of the 3rd round onwards, they may activate any Group.

12.1.3 Layouts

Roll a D6 to determine the layout to be used in the Scenario. Re-roll results of 4 or more for competitive games.

Players alternate placing Micrometeor Clouds and Dense Fields. Planetary Rings and Large Objects are placed according to the scenario layout diagram.

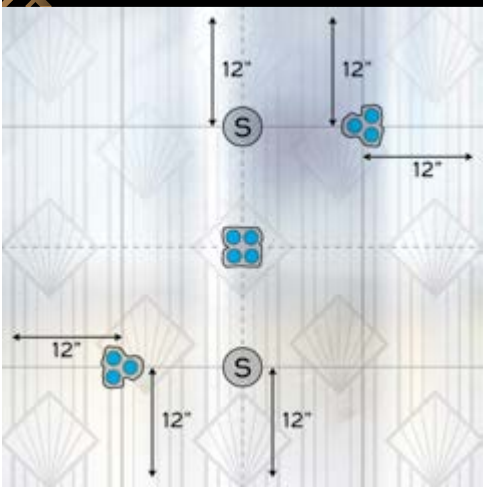
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D6 Result	Approach Type	Red Team Deployment	Blue Team Deployment
1	Standoff	Directly Deploy	Directly Deploy
2	Close Enough	Close	Close
3	Column	Distant	Distant
4	Counterattack	Directly Deploy	Close
5	Delayed Response	Close	Distant
6	Home Fleet Disadvantage	Close	Directly Deploy



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1 – Diagonal

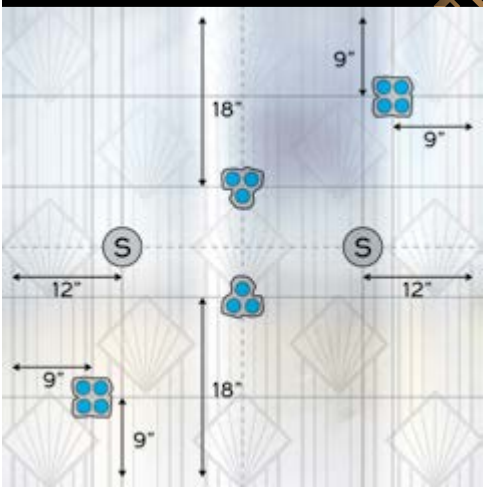


Scenery:

4-6 Micrometeor Clouds

4 Dense Fields

2 – Edge Case

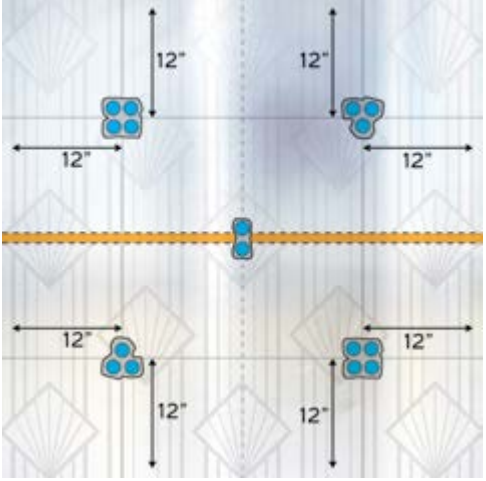


Scenery:

4 Micrometeor Clouds

6 Dense Fields

3 – Eruption

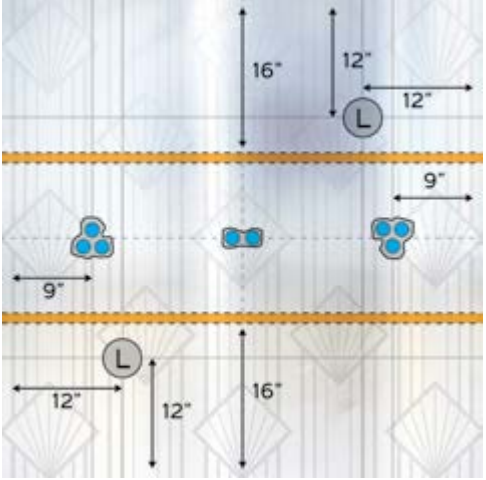


Scenery:

1 Planetary Ring across the centre of the table as shown in orange.

4-6 Micrometeor Clouds

4 – Gatecrash



Scenery:

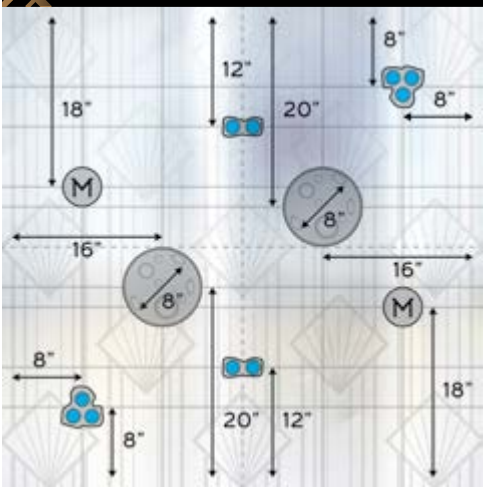
2 Planetary Rings as shown in orange.

4 Micrometeor Clouds

2 Dense Fields

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5 – Moonlight



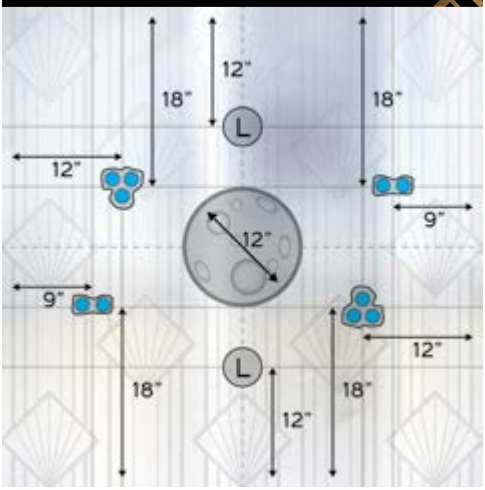
Scenery:

2 8" Large Objects

2 Micrometeor Clouds

2 Dense Fields

6 – Moonstruck



Scenery:

1 12" Large Object

6 Micrometeor Clouds



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Think of the galaxy as a savanna. The Shaltari are the birds. The Scourge are the termites. You are the lions. They are the trophy hunters. You have roared exceedingly, and hunters are uninterested in cubs. Aurellia Felix on the Bioficers, Aurum, 2679

12.1.4 Variants

Each of the following variants alters the Dropsites shown in the Layouts section. If the result alters something that is not present, only apply the relevant effects.

D6 Result	Variant	Effect
1	Guarded Sectors	Each Dropsite gains a ◆ Military Outpost and each Large Dropsite also gains an ■ Orbital Defence Gun. If the Deployment type uses a Defender, the Defender may place an additional ◆ Military Outpost in any Dropsite.
2	Secure Comms Array	Each Medium City (or Small Cities if the scenario has no Medium Cities) gains a ◎ Comms Station. Replace each Large City with a Large Space Station containing an ■ Orbital Defence Gun and ϟ Power Plant.
3	Battlescarred	Each player places an additional piece of Micrometeor Cloud and Dense Field. These additional pieces should be placed partially over a piece of the same type to create larger areas. Each Medium City and Medium Space Station gain two ϟ Power Plants.
4	Gridlocked	Each Dropsite gains a ϟ Power Plant. Replace each Medium City with a Medium Space Station. These Stations gain a ◆ Military Outpost, ■ Orbital Defence Gun, and a ▲ Hangar.
5	Expansive Atmosphere	Groups on Course Change and Max Thrust orders suffer 1 hit at the end of their activation and may use their Energy or Kinetic save against it Ships may launch Ground Assets at Dropsites in any Orbital Layer. Each Red player may place 2 Features of their choice on a Dropsite. Then each Blue player may place 2 Features of their choice on any other Dropsite.
6	Orbital Complex	Replace each City with a Space Station of equal size. Each Space Station gains a ◆ Military Outpost. Only Orbit is used. Orbital Decay tokens cause a Ship to take D3 damage at the end of its activation. Colossal Ships take 2D3 damage instead.

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12.1.5 Objectives

12.1.5.1 Standard Scoring

Players are awarded the following Standard VP for Controlling and Contesting the Scenario Objectives. Points for Levelled/ Ruined are only awarded if specifically stated. Most Scenarios will have additional or alternative objectives to complete, though any that use Standard Scoring will use this table.

Standard Scoring awards VP during the Victory Points step of the End Phase on rounds 4 and 6.

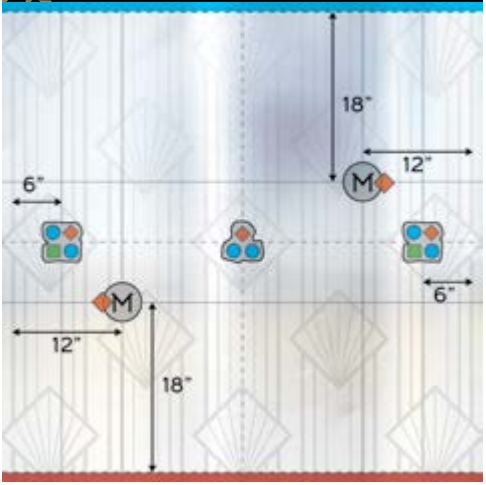
Dropsite Size	Control / Levelled	Contest / Ruined
Small	2VP	0VP
Medium	3VP	1VP
Large	4VP	2VP

D6 Result	Variant	Effect
1	Attrition	Standard Scoring. Players are awarded 2VP at the end of the game for every 500 points of Ships and Admirals they have destroyed.
2	Survey	Standard Scoring Players are awarded 1VP whenever they Survey Dropsites. Any Capital Ship within 6" of the Dropsite and able to fire Weapons may substitute all attacking and launching that round to Survey it. Each Dropsite may be Surveyed once per player per game
3	Extract	Place 1 Recon Operatives token on Small Dropsites, 2 tokens on Medium Dropsites, and 3 tokens on Large Dropsites. If a Ship may launch Assets to deploy a Battalion token to that Dropsite, they may instead Extract Recon Operatives from that Dropsite equal to the number of Battalions that would be placed. The Extracting Ship gains those Recon Operatives. A Ship cannot Extract more Recon Operatives than the Dropsite has. Players are awarded 2VP at the end of the game for each Recon Operative token left aboard their Ships. Players are awarded 1VP at the end of the game for each enemy Ship they have destroyed with any number of Recon Operatives. Once onboard a Ship, Recon Operatives cannot be removed. Recon Operatives on Payload Ships are transferred to a Porter Ship when the Payload Ship attaches to it.
4	Protect	Standard Scoring. At the start of the game, after determining Initiative, each player nominates a single different Dropsite in Initiative order. Each player is awarded additional Standard Scoring for controlling/ contesting their nominated Dropsite if that Dropsite is not Levelled/Ruined. At the end of the game, players are subtracted Standard Scoring if their Dropsite has been levelled.
5	Breakthrough	Red Players may permanently fly Ships off the board in any opponent's Deployment Zone. For every 200pts in Ships Players fly off, they are awarded 1VP at the end of the game. Other Players are awarded 2VP at the end of the game for every 500 points of Ships and Admirals they have destroyed.
6	Raze	At the end of the game, players are awarded double Standard Scoring for each Dropsite that has been Levelled/Ruined that is 24" or more away from their Deployment Zone (regardless of who Levelled/Ruined those Dropsites). Players are awarded 2VP at the end of the game for every 500 points of Ships and Admirals they have destroyed.

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12.2 Standard Scenarios

Take and Hold



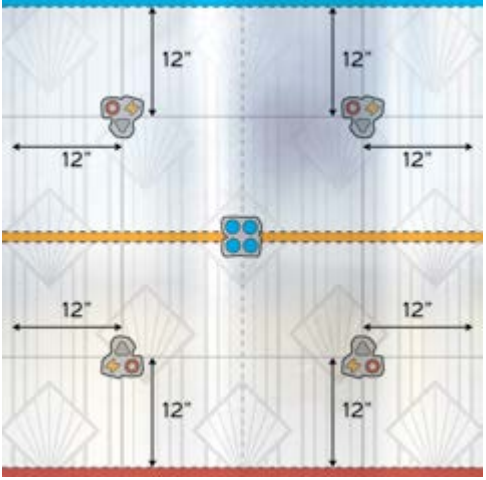
Players: 2 players.

Scenery: 4 Micrometeor Clouds, 4 Dense Fields.

Deployment: All players Close.

Scoring: Survey.

Erupting Battlefront



Players: 2 players.

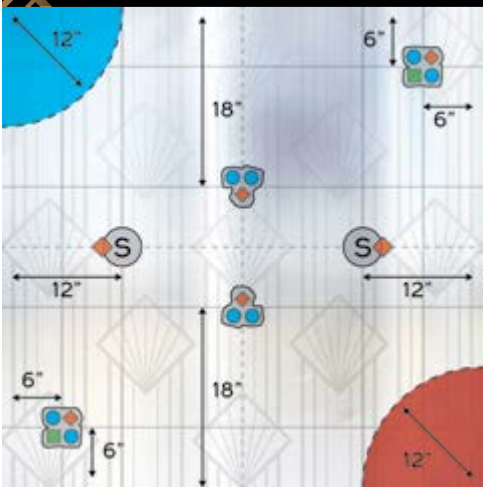
Scenery: 1 Planetary Ring, 4 Micrometeor Clouds.

Deployment: All players Distant.

Scoring: Raze.

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Power Grab



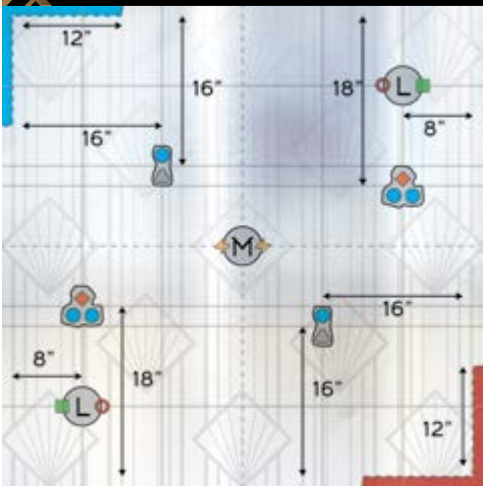
Players: 2 players.

Scenery: 6 Micrometeor Clouds, 4 Dense Fields.

Deployment: All players Distant.

Scoring: Attrition.

Shock And Yaw



Players: 2 players.

Scenery: 2-5 Micrometeor Clouds, 4-6 Dense Fields.

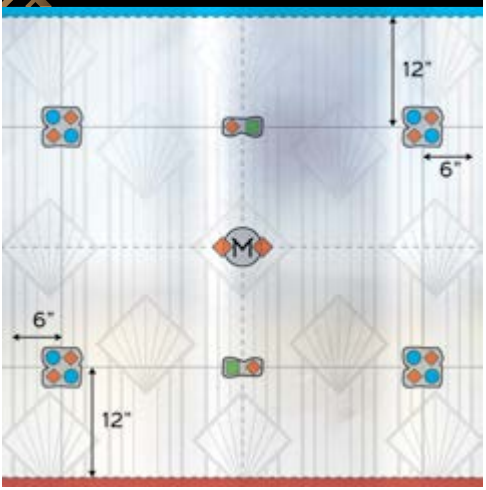
Deployment Type: All players Distant.

Scoring: Protect.

Special Rules: Instead of its normal effect, destroying a ⚡Power Plant Feature does not deal additional damage to the Medium Space Station but causes all Groups within 6" to gain two Spikes and all Ships within 6" to gain a Scanners Offline token.

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Orbital Support



Players: 2 players.

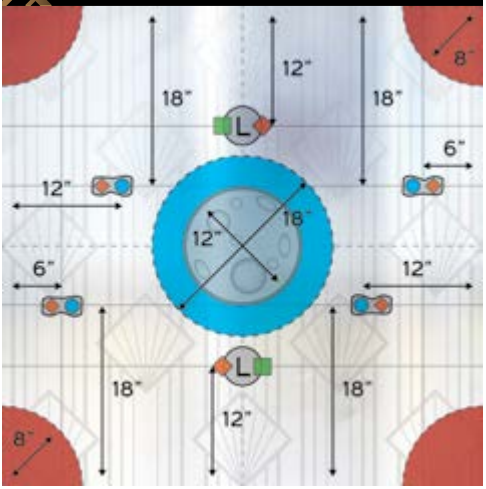
Scenery: 2-5 Micrometeor Clouds, 4-6 Dense Fields.

Deployment: All players Distant.

Scoring: Raze.

Variant: The Medium Space Station replaces its two ◆ Military Outposts with two ▲ Hangars.

Entrapmoont



Players: 2-4 players, 1 attacking team in red, 1 defending team in blue.

Scenery: 1 12" Heavy Large Object (as shown), 6 Micrometeor Clouds.

Deployment Type: Blue Directly Deploys, Red Deploys Close.

Scoring: Attackers-Raze, Defenders-Protect.

Special Rules: At the start of the first Planning Phase of the game, the team in blue may place one additional Military Outpost in any Dropsite.

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12.3 Secondary Objectives

Choose two Secondary Objectives when building your Fleet. These can be completed during the game and award additional VP for completing them.

When you complete a Secondary Objective, declare it. At the end of the game, you may choose **one** of your Secondary Objectives to gain VP from.

Secondary Objectives that require you to nominate something must be declared to all opponents prior to the 1st Planning Phase of the game.

12.3.1 Key Site

Nominate one Dropsite at least 24" from your Deployment Zone before the game. If you Control it at the end of the game, gain 2 VP. If this Dropsite is within 6" or inside your opponent's Deployment Zone, gain 3VP instead.

12.3.2 Priority Target

Nominate one Medium or Large Dropsite at least 24" from your Deployment Zone before the game. If you have Levelled it, at the end of the game gain 2VP. If this Dropsite is within 6" or inside your opponent's Deployment zone, gain 3VP instead.

12.3.3 Long Shot

Nominate one Feature in a Dropsite within 12" of an opponent's Deployment Zone before the game. If you have destroyed it, or a deployed enemy Deployable Feature within 12" of their Deployment Zone at the end of the game, gain 2VP. Each Feature can only be nominated once but a Dropsite can have more than one nominated Feature.

12.3.4 Annihilate

You are awarded 1VP at the end of the game for every 500 points of Ships and Admirals you have destroyed. A maximum of 3VP may be scored using this Secondary Objective.

12.3.5 Take Prizes

You are awarded 1VP at the end of the game for every 100 points of Ships you have captured. A maximum of 3VP may be scored using this Secondary Objective.

12.3.6 Gather Intel

You are awarded 1VP whenever you survey a Dropsite over 24" away from your deployment zone. Any Capital Ship within 6" of the Dropsite and able to fire Weapons may substitute all attacking and launching that round to Survey it. Each Dropsite may be Surveyed once per player per game. A maximum of 2VP may be scored using this Secondary Objective. If the Scenario normally uses Survey, these VP are scored in addition to those in the Scenario.

12.3.7 Decapitate

You are awarded 2VP if an opponent's highest-level Admiral has been killed for any reason (or one of if there are multiple with the same Level).

12.3.8 Objectives Beyond

Nominate one of your Ships of Tonnage M or higher. You may permanently fly that Ship off the board in any opponent's Deployment Zone. If you do and that Ship is not Crippled, gain 1VP. If that ship was H or C tonnage, gain 2VP instead.

12.4 Kill Points & Ties

Kill Points are the total points in Admirals and Ships you have destroyed. In the event of a tie in VP, the victor is determined by who has the most Kill Points

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13. Competitive Play

13.1 Two Lists

For a tournament or competitive campaign, consider allowing players to bring two Fleet Lists to use throughout the event.

Limiting players to a single faction is recommended when allowing two Fleet Lists.

Lists should be chosen before each game once both players know the Scenario and which faction their opponent will be using.

I skid over the blood-slicked deck and slam into a barricade. I grip my wrench, peek over—they're coming, the things. The way they move together, nothing like living things at all, and the silence, just synchronised clunk clunks of bare, bony feet on deck and the whisper whoosh whoosh of red beams zipping above. Jackson gets one in the face, and his head's just gone. He drops in a waft of grey smoke, gushing. There's no more screams. It's just me. Clunk clunk clunk. I squeeze, tense—

Three of those armoured PHR guys charge past and open up—full auto, deafening. They're with us for deck protection, thank all hell. The things don't dodge, but only go down when they're shot to tatters and don't work no more. One PHR guy gets hit, staggers, falls. Grey smoke curls between his undamaged plate. Another goes down. The last tosses a grenade—boom. The PHR's thrown onto his back. Chunks of skinless alien meat flop down around me.

But there, through the smoke—Christ, that one's huge, but no gun. Out of ammo? It lumbers in—too fast for something that big. It's got the PHR in huge, clawed fists. It rips him in half. Then it sees me.

13.2 Scenario Selection

When deciding upon scenarios for competitive play, it is best to hand pick either pre-built scenarios or generate bespoke scenarios using the scenario generation tables ahead of time. It's best to purposefully choose each element instead of rolling dice.

While you could choose any Standard, random, or pre-generated scenario, tournament organisers are advised to meet the following:

- Across all the event's Scenarios, Dropsites should be roughly 50/50 Space Stations/Cities.
- At least one should use a Large Object.
- All should allow Secondary Objectives.
- You may allow Secondary Objectives to be kept secret from opponents.
- Variety is good—avoid similar Scenarios.
- At least one should feature corner Deployment Zones.
- Use plenty of Scenery—generally the maximum suggested by the Scenario.



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14. Special Rules

14.1 Ship Special Rules

14.1.1 Aegis-X

All Ships with this rule in a Group in coherency combine their X values into a single value Y.

Friendly Groups in coherency within 6" of a Ship with this rule and the same Orbital Layer (including its own Group) gain the benefits of Aegis.

When rolling saves against Close Action and Bomber (of any type) attacks, those Groups gain Y additional save dice they may add to their Energy or Kinetic saves. Before rolling to save, the defending player assigns these dice against specific weapons, divided up as they choose (including any modified hits) between any Energy or Kinetic saves.

An Aegis Group can only grant the benefits of Aegis once each time a friendly group is attacked.

A friendly Group can only benefit from Aegis from one Group each time it is attacked.

Aegis has no effect on Backup saves or saves that replace Energy and Kinetic saves (such as Shield saves)."

In addition, Ships benefiting from Aegis increase the number of bombers required to trigger Saturation Fire by Y.

e.g. A Ship benefiting from Aegis-2 would suffer one Core hit per bomber above 8, rather than 6."

14.1.2 Cloak-X

This Group may have a maximum of X Spikes.

14.1.3 Command Ship-X

Increase the Level of any Admiral assigned to this Ship by X.

14.1.4 Descent

This special rule confers various benefits covered in the core rules.

14.1.5 Detector

If this Ship is on an order that allows it to attack, this Ship may forgo one allowed Weapon use during its activation. If it does, at the end of its activation place two Spikes on an enemy Group in line of sight. A Group that uses Detector gains a Spike (regardless of the amount of Ships using this rule).

e.g. A Ship with 1 Weapon and Detector on General Quarters would be able to either attack with its single Weapon or use its Detector rule.

14.1.6 Escort

At the start of the game, before deployment, assign this Group to escort a friendly Group of H or C Tonnage. An Escort Group and its escorted Group are a pair, no other Groups can be part of this pair. Until either Group is destroyed, the pair activate and perform their actions (moving, turning, attacking, etc) simultaneously and count as a single Group when generating pass tokens. The pair do not need to choose the same Order when they activate. Escort Groups are deployed alongside their escorted Group, ignoring tonnage restrictions for the Escort Group. The pair do not need to be in coherency, however while both Groups are within 6" of each other they ignore Saturation Fire from enemy Bombers

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14.1.7 Gateship-X

Shaltari Motherships must launch their Dropships via a Ship/Dropsite with this rule (sometimes referred to as Gateships). Each Gateship can have up to X Dropships deployed from it each round. Note: though the launch is measured from the Gateship, it is the Mothership that is launching.

When this Ship goes on the Max Thrust or Damage Control orders, it reduces its Gateship-X value to 0 until the start of its next activation.

14.1.8 Marines-X

Remove X enemy Battalions from this Ship at the beginning of the Battalion Combat step.

14.1.9 Monitor

Ships with this rule may not use Course Change or Max Thrust orders.

14.1.10 Mothership

Shaltari Motherships can only deploy their Dropships via friendly Ships or controlled Dropsites with the Gateship-X special rule (sometimes referred to as Gateships).

These Gateships must be within 18" of the Mothership or part of a chain of Gateships with each Gateship in the chain being within 18" of another. Note: though the launch is measured from the Gateship, it is the Mothership that is launching.

14.1.11 Payload S/L-X

When building your fleet, you may choose as many Payload Ships as you like—tonnage limits do not apply to these Ships, and they have no Group size. All Payload S/L Ships must be assigned to a Porter S/L Ship with the same letter. Payload Ships may not activate or be targeted until detached.

Payload Ships take up X of a Porter Ship's capacity.

During the Porter Ship's activation, if it is on an Order that allows it to Launch, you may detach one or more of its Payload Ships and place them within 3" of it. In the round they are detached, these Payloads activate together immediately as part of the Porter Ship's activation after it has completed its Order. In subsequent rounds, all your Payload Ships count as being part of a single Group. Crippling Effects, Spikes, and other rules that affect an entire Group only affect the targeted Payload Ship.

Payload Ships always follow General Quarters Orders, even if its Porter is on different Orders. **Payload Ships ignore Coherency rules** (and do not gain Formation Benefits), have no Lead Ship, are targeted by attacks individually, and these attacks can only damage the targeted Payload Ship.

If a Payload Ship is attached to a Porter Ship when that Ship is destroyed, the Payload Ship is destroyed.

14.1.12 Porter S/L-X

This Ship may be assigned Payload Ships with the same letter up to a total capacity of X."

During a Porter's activation, it may attach any detached Payload Ships within 3" if it has available capacity. Payload Ships reattached to a Porter Ship are removed from the table to be deployed in a later round.

Any tokens, Spikes, or effects affecting the reattached Payload Ship are removed from that Ship.

14.1.13 Rapid Drop

This Ship may launch its Assets at any point during its movement.

14.1.14 Rare

You may only take one Group of this Ship in a Skirmish-sized game, two in a Clash, three in a Battle, and four in a Reconquest.

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14.1.15 Regenerate-X

This Ship recovers X lost Hull Points at the end of its activation.

14.1.16 Shield-X

This Group/Dropsite has an unmodifiable Shield save of X+.

At the start of this Group's or controlled Dropsite's activation, you may choose to raise its shields. If you do, this group gains a shields token until the start of its next activation.

While a Group/Dropsite has a shields token, it replaces its Energy and Kinetic saves with its Shield save and triples its Signature value (before Spikes). Shield saves are used against all hits from weapons before making Backup saves. Shield saves must be used before making Backup saves against Core hits. After being attacked, a Group with a shields token gains a Spike.

A Group on Silent Running loses any shields tokens it has and cannot have shields tokens.

Groups that Directly Deploy may start the game with a shields token.

Core Hits caused by Boarding Actions and Saturation Fire cannot be saved by Shield Saves.

14.1.17 Stealth

This Ship may fire one Weapon while Silent Running.

14.1.18 Unique

You may only take one Group of this Ship.

14.1.19 Vectored

This Ship may make an additional turn, up to 45 degrees, at any point during its movement, regardless of the Order its Group has taken.

14.1.20 Impetuous

At the start of each round, friendly Groups with this rule improve the Lock of their Weapon Systems by 1 until you activate a friendly Group without this rule.

14.1.221 Reinforced Armour

Weapons rolling to hit this Ship or its Group can only score criticals against it on a result of a 3 higher than its Lock value.

14.1.22 Vanguard-X"

Groups with this rule may begin the game Directly Deployed, ignoring the normal Scenario Deployment and Approach Types (though still counting towards Groups Directly Deployed). If it does, it may be deployed up to X" away from your Deployment Zone.

14.1.23 Hero

You can only include two Groups with this special rule in your fleet. You cannot assign an Admiral to this Ship when building your fleet.

14.1.24 Boardable

This Ship can have Battalions Assigned to it as if it were a Space Station.

At the start of the round, this Ship is controlled by a Player if only they have any Battalions on it, lasting until the end of the round.

Players that control a Boardable Ship may activate it as if it were a Ship in their Fleet, after all other Groups have activated.

14.1.25 Civilian Transport

This Ship can only choose the General Quarters order.

This Ship cannot be attacked unless it is controlled by a player. Players cannot attack a friendly Civilian Transport.

The Controlling player cannot target this Ship with Abilities.

14.1.26 Mercenary (X)

This Ship may be used in X faction Fleets. When taken as part of your fleet, this Ship loses its Boardable and Civilian Transport rules.

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14.2 Weapon Special Rules

14.2.1 Air to Air

This weapon ignores the penalties for attacking Ships in Atmosphere while the attacker is also in Atmosphere.

14.2.2 Alt-X

Only one Weapon or Load with the same Alt value on the same Ship may be used by that Ship each round.

All Alt Weapons with the same value count as the same Weapon when determining how many Weapons a Ship has.

14.2.3 Alt Launch

In a round this Weapon is fired this Ship may not launch Assets.

14.2.4 Arrest-X

A Ship damaged by this Weapon reduces its Thrust by X" during its next activation. A Ship affected by this rule multiple times before it activates uses the highest X value it is affected by to determine its Thrust reduction.

14.2.5 Bloom-X

When you attack with this Weapon System (including separate attacks generated by the Volley-X special rule), the attacking Group gains X Spikes.

14.2.6 Bombardment

This Weapon ignores the penalties for attacking Cities and Ships in Atmosphere.

Improve the Lock of this Weapon by 2 when attacking Cities.

When attacking a Ship in Orbit with this weapon, it always hits on a 6+ and can never cause a critical.

This weapon cannot be used to attack Ships in Orbit **while the attacking Ship is in Atmosphere**

14.2.7 Burnthrough-X

Each of this Weapon's critical hits reduces the target's Energy/Kinetic Save by X for hits caused by this Weapon for this attack. Saves made for other Weapons are unaffected. Roll attacks separately for each Burnthrough Weapon.

14.2.8 Calibre-X

Improve the Lock value of this Weapon by 1 when attacking Groups of any of the listed X Tonnage values.

14.2.9 Close Action

This weapon does not benefit from Formation Benefits and can only be assigned to targets within Scan range and on the same Orbital Layer as the attacker.

14.2.10 Corruptor-X

When this Weapon successfully inflicts damage, place X Battalions on the target.

14.2.11 Crippling-X

If an attack from this Weapon scores at least one Critical hit and then damages a Ship (following normal damage allocation rules), the damaged Ship gains the stated X Crippling Effect regardless of Tonnage. If no effect is listed, roll 2D6 and apply the corresponding Crippling Effect (from the Crippling Effect table).

Crippling Effects caused by Crippling Weapons are in addition to those caused by 7.3.6 Roll for Crippling Effects.

Except for Fire, **a Ship can only have one of each type of Crippling Effect token at a time** (Spikes are not a Crippling Effect), even when placed from different sources or at different times. Any duplicate effects are ignored and discarded.

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14.2.12 Critical–X

Each of this Weapon's criticals increases the damage of that hit by X.

E.g. A Critical-2 weapon rolls 2 dice to attack, one is a hit and the other is a critical. The hit deals its normal damage while the critical increases the damage it causes by 2.

14.2.13 Escape Velocity

This weapon ignores the penalty for attacking Ships in Orbit and treats all Ships in Atmosphere as non-Descent Ships, so only reduces its Lock by 1 when attacking Ships in Atmosphere.

Close Action weapons with this special rule may be used against targets in Orbit while the attacking Ship is in Atmosphere.

14.2.14 Flash–X

When this Weapon inflicts damage, the damaged Group (or Ship if it ignores the usual coherency rules) gains X Spikes.

14.2.15 Focused

Instead of the normal potential targets for Weapons, this Weapon's potential targets are either:

- A single enemy Ship.
- A Dropsite containing no friendly Battalions.

Damage caused by this Weapon is allocated to only the target.

14.2.16 Fusillade–X

This Weapon increases its Attack value by X while its Ship is on Weapons Free.

14.2.17 High Power

Unless the attacking Ship is on the Weapons Free Order, attacking with this Weapon counts as attacking with two Weapons (though it only fires once).

Ships with only a single High Power Weapon can only attack with it while on the Weapons Free Order.

14.2.18 Impel–X

If an attacking Group scores at least X critical hits with this Weapon System against a Group, choose one of the following for each affected Group:

- Turn all Ships in that Group 45 degrees in the same direction. If the Group scored at least twice X, turn all Ships in that Group 90 degrees in the same direction instead.
- Move all Ships in that Group up to twice X in inches directly forward (measuring from the affected Ships). Ships moved this way cannot be moved into Large Objects or off of the table.

A Group can only be affected by each effect once per Weapon System per attack sequence.

14.2.19 Limited–X

This Weapon can only be fired X times per game.

You may launch a total of X of this Asset per game.

E.g. an asset with Launch 2 & Limited-4 can launch as 2 sets of 2 assets, or up to 4 launches of a single asset.

14.2.20 Linked–X

Weapons with the same Linked-X value on the same Ship count as 1 Weapon for Orders purposes. When you attack with a Linked-X Weapon, you attack with all other Weapons on that Ship with the same Linked-X value.

14.2.21 Low Power

If a Ship's Orders allow it to fire Close Action Weapons, it may attack with one Low Power Weapon in addition to any other Weapons allowed by its Order.

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14.2.22 Mauler

The Lock value of this weapon is equal to the target's save value against this weapon's Type.

E.g., A Kinetic Mauler Weapon attacking a target with 3+ Kinetic Save would have a lock value of 3+.

14.2.23 Overcharge

Before assigning Weapons to targets, you may double the Damage value of this Weapon. If you do, this becomes a High-Power Weapon for this activation and each attack roll of 6 causes that attacking Ship to lose this Weapon's unmodified Damage value in hull points. Only one Weapon per Ship may benefit from this rule per activation.

14.2.24 Penetrator

Each of this Weapon's critical hits cause a Core hit instead of its normal Damage Type.

14.2.25 Re-Entry

This weapon ignores the penalties for attacking Ships in Atmosphere while the attacking Ship is in Orbit.

Close Action weapons with this special rule may be used against targets in Atmosphere while the attacking Ship is in Orbit.

14.2.26 Scald-X

If this weapon attacks a target within Scan range of the attacking Ship, reduce the target's Energy / Kinetic save against this weapon's hits by X (other attacks and weapons are unaffected).

14.2.27 Status

When you hit with this Weapon, pick one of the following tokens; Defence Systems Offline, Scanners Offline, or Navigation Offline.

At the end of the Inflict Damage step, for each unsaved hit from this weapon, choose one of the defending Ships to gain the selected token, regardless of the amount of damage caused by those hits.

This token is automatically removed at the end of the affected ship's next activation or the start of the next End Phase, before making repairs (whichever is first).

Tokens gained from this rule are counted separately from normal Crippling Effects. A Ship may only have one of each type of these tokens gained due to this rule.

14.2.28 Sustained Fire

If this Weapon attacks a target Group it hit in the previous round, double its Attack value for this attack.

14.2.29 Volley-X

This Weapon counts as 1 Weapon System for Orders purposes. When you assign this Weapon to a target, you assign it to targets up to X times (either the same or different). Once assigned, treat each allocation as a separate weapon for the subsequent steps in the attack sequence.

Broadside Weapons using Volley must alternate arcs when determining and assigning targets (so cannot target the same Group on the same side twice in a row).

14.2.30 Reave-X

Each of this Weapon's criticals reduces the Energy/Kinetic save used against that hit by X.

E.g. a Reave-1 weapon rolls 3 dice to attack, one is a hit and the other two are a critical. The hit is saved against using the target's normal save value, the criticals are saved against using the target's save value reduced by X.

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14.2.31 Anti Wing

This weapon may target enemy Wings as if they were Ships (with a Sig of 0") but reduces its Lock value by 1 for that attack. If it does, for each hit, remove 1 Fighter or 1 Bomber from that Wing or any other enemy Wing within 3" of the target.

When this weapon is assigned to a Torpedo, it reduces its Lock value by 1 instead of always hitting on a 6+."

14.2.32 Point Blank

A weapon with this rule can only be assigned targets in base contact and on the same Orbital Layer. This Weapon counts as a Close Action weapon for Orders purposes. This Weapon cannot target Cities.

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